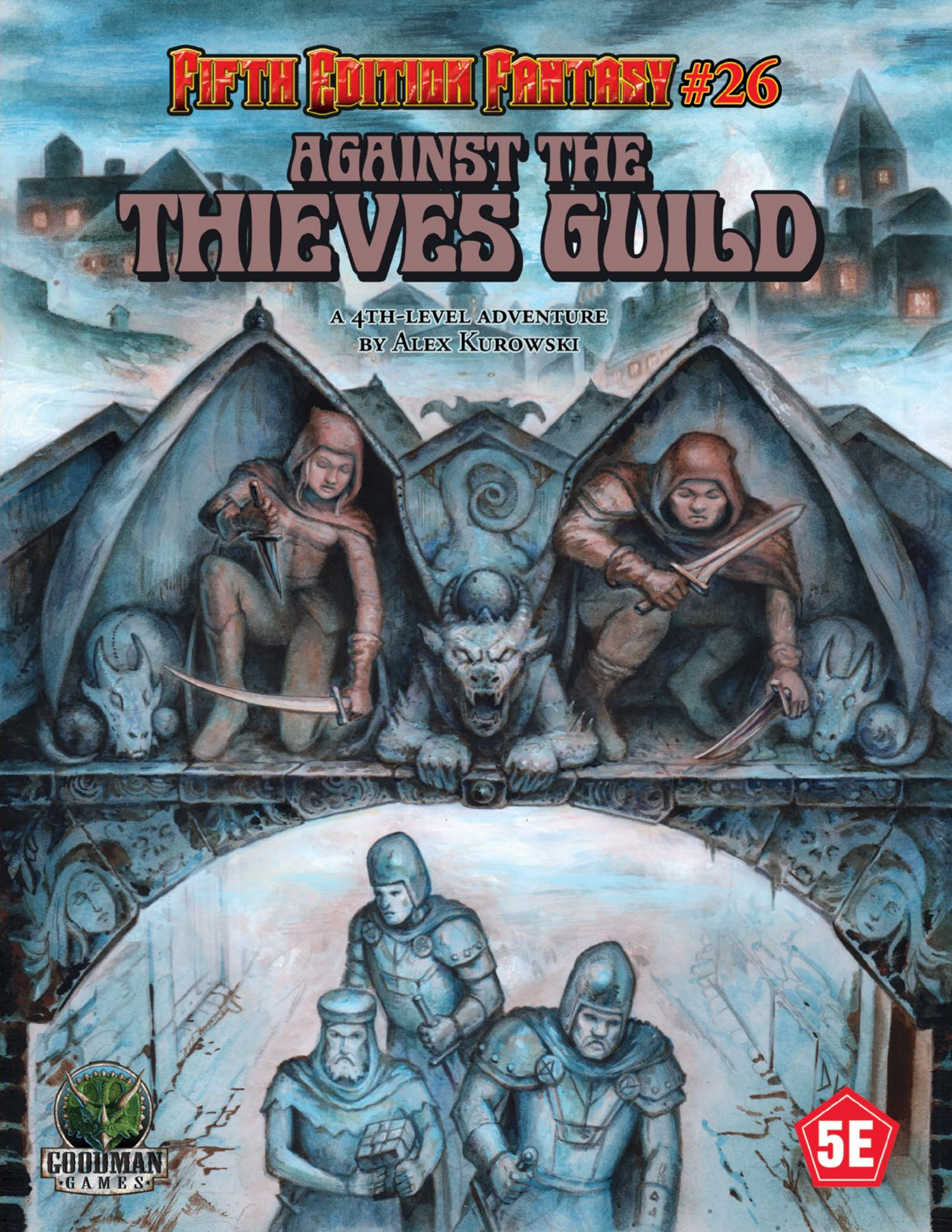
Fifth Edition Fantasy #26

Against the Thieves Guild

A 4th-level adventure
by Alex Kurowski



Goodman Games

5E



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AGAINST THE THIEVES' GUILD

by Alex Kurowski

Against the Thieves' Guild is an adventure designed for use with the fifth edition of the original fantasy roleplaying game. It is intended for four to six 4th-level characters and can be completed in two or more sessions. The adventure starts with the characters delving into the Labyrinth of Oathsworn Silence in pursuit of a valuable religious object. During the adventure the characters will be forced to navigate past traps which reflect a bitter rivalry between two infamous thieves belonging to the Gravelight Sorority.

BACKGROUND

United by mutual ambition and friendship, Lyria and Dara rose to prominence as notorious thieves within the twisted alleys of the city of Nighthaven. Their combined ingenuity and cunning catapulted them up the ranks of the Gravelight Sorority. Every coin and treasure pilfered not only fortified the guild's coffers, but also their reputation. Most notable among their escapades was the theft of a religious artifact from a sect of monastics devoted to a revered god of secrets. As the story was shared and retold, Lyria emerged as its main character and heralded as the mastermind, earning her the title of the criminal syndicate's guildmaster.

Dara's initial support for her friend soon turned to a burning envy, setting her calculating mind toward dark conspiracies. Over the years, their bond slowly cracked until it finally shattered. Dara felt overshadowed and underappreciated, believing her contributions to Lyria's success had gone unrecognized. Whispers of dissent made their way through the ranks, and Dara initiated a coup to challenge her friend's stewardship. The subsequent power struggle consumed the Gravelight Sorority, continuing until Lyria's grip on power ultimately slipped away.

Lyria was dethroned and exiled, but not broken. She disappeared from Nighthaven, seeking refuge among the very monastics she and Dara had robbed early in their roguish careers. She vowed to reclaim their most sacred treasure—the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*—and restore it to its rightful owners. Through manipulation, she convinced the monastics she would right her wrongs by fortifying their sanctuary against future theft by installing traps and magical wards. With their compliance, she meticulously rigged the sanctum with devious mechanisms designed specifically for one victim. Her preparations complete, only one task remained: setting the stage for her ultimate revenge.

After infiltrating the Gravelight Sorority's vaults, Lyria reclaimed the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* and left clues to lead Dara and the other traitorous rogues to where she had hidden the object. Fearing the loss of the object threatened the guild's reputation, Dara sent numerous agents from the Gravelight to recapture the relic. Through repeated attempts by the thieves' guild, the dungeon claimed many lives and the very existence of the Gravelight Sorority.

As years have drifted by, memory of the labyrinth has faded into antiquity. The monastics have all perished, leaving nothing behind but the remains of their ruined convent. Yet, remnants of Lyria's taunting messages to her former allies still occasionally surface, ensnaring the curiosity of daring adventurers who are lured to the dark corners of Lyria's maze in pursuit of the lost treasure.

ADVENTURE HOOKS

Here are a few suggested hooks to use to bring the characters into the adventure:

- A follower of Lorlana approaches the adventurers about traveling to the Labyrinth of Oathsworn Silence. The follower has heard the whispers of her patron, who wishes for the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* to be reclaimed from Lyria and sanctified. The location of the labyrinth is shared with the party and a reward is offered for assisting with its retrieval.
- An elderly former member of the now-defunct Gravelight Sorority approaches the adventurers to sell a treasure map. It charts a path through Tornheim into the mountains to a place said to hold a worthy treasure. Age precludes them from venturing to the map's destination and they are down on their luck, willing to sell the map for a mere 50 gp. Scrawled upon the parchment is a personal note: "Dara, to reclaim what I have stolen from you requires following in my shadow once more. Beware, by the end of your search the Reliquary of the Silent Sisters may only be the second most precious thing you have lost. - L."

- The game master can use any object relevant to their campaign world to motivate the characters to seek adventure within the Labyrinth of Oathsworn Silence. The *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* is easily substituted for a different item prized by the Gravelight Sorority which would lure the thieves' guild to have pursued Lyria's dungeon. Under this scenario, Lyria's curse is derived not from the *Reliquary* but as a divine curse Lorlana exerts upon her as punishment for defiling her sacred halls and killing her worshipers. Lyria is thus found in area 2-10 stricken with paranoia, obsessively guarding over the prized possession.

BEGINNING THE ADVENTURE

Against the Thieves' Guild begins with the party traveling to a remote location within the broken lands known as Tornheim. This unforgiving landscape is marked by twisting ravines and narrow canyons. The party arrives after having made an exhausting journey through harsh conditions.

A winding path through a narrow chasm leads to an abandoned edifice, formerly a convent which housed Lorlana's devoted servants. Read the following as the party ascends the path:

After days of relentless travel across the unyielding expanse of Tornheim, your party has navigated through a treacherous track threaded through twisting ravines and unstable footpaths. Throughout the journey, the landscape has remained a bleak canvas utterly devoid of any color of life. Only a monotonous spectrum of grays and browns from the jagged earth which dominates the terrain yields any attempt challenging the imagination.

Respite from the unchanging conditions arrives as you ascend a weathered trail to the sight of an ancient, dilapidated village. A solemn silence hangs over the crumbling structures interrupted only by the occasional gust of wind. Amidst the surrounding ruins, only a modest temple at the center stands out as having survived the ravages of time.

Adjacent to the village, the yawning entrance to a cavern beckons. Flanking the cavern entrance, two imposing statues stand sentinel, each carved meticulously from marble. Both statues depict female priests donned in humble headscarves. While their features are exquisitely rendered, the intentional absence of their mouths evokes a profound sense of awe tinged with unease.

The characters may decide to search the abandoned village for information. There is little here that hasn't already been looted or deteriorated with time. However, a character searching the chapel who succeeds on a DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check will find underneath some rubble a leatherbound tome with a symbol embossed in its cover. The symbol appears as three interlacing circles surrounding a pair of closed lips. The pages are all blank, though a candle held beneath reveals its text. A character who succeeds on a DC 16 Intelligence (Religion) check can determine that this is a ritual book for worshipers of Lorlana, and the GM can summarize the information in the sidebar regarding Lorlana.

Lorlana, The Vigilant Silence

Lorlana is a minor demigod of silence, secrets, and discretion. Her followers are often spies and guardians of forbidden knowledge, though many others seek her unique blessings. The Labyrinth of Oathsworn Silence represents the only formal site where followers would congregate in knowing recognition of one another. Under the watchful eyes of a devout order of monastics, the labyrinth was designed to be a place of meditation, where one could unburden themselves of their coveted secrets to Lorlana. The labyrinth's walls act as a conduit to Lorlana, who safeguards such information from others, including their keepers.

Certain secrets entrusted to the divine were deemed worthy of reward. A gemstone, sum of coin, or other treasure was granted to those who made an offering of distinction. The monastics who served as custodians for the labyrinth safeguarded both the *Reliquary* and Lorlana's treasury. As legends often do, the revered *Reliquary* and the vaults where it was kept spiraled into the world of myth and speculation.

LEVEL 1: THE LABYRINTH OF OATHSWORN SILENCE

Beneath the ruins of the monastery lies a network of halls which were originally a maze designed for meditation before Lyria claimed it for her own purposes. Many of the traps on this first level were constructed by Lyria to taunt her former partner-in-crime.

GENERAL FEATURES

Dungeon Level 1 is depicted on **Maps 1**, **1A**, **1B**, and **1C**.

Construction. The dungeon and its chambers are assembled from worked granite stone.

Ceilings. Ceilings in hallways are 8 feet high and within rooms are 12 feet high, unless otherwise noted.

Illumination. The entirety of the labyrinth is unlit unless otherwise noted.

Doors. Unless otherwise noted, all doors are made of stone (AC 17, 22 hit points, immunity to poison and psychic damage, resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage).

Secret Doors. Secret doors, unless otherwise noted, can be spotted with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. Identifying how one opens requires 10 minutes and a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) check.

"I Check for Traps"

As adventurers navigate the Labyrinth of Oathsworn Silence, searching for traps is an essential task for survival. The following guidelines assist the GM in managing a trap-laden environment and help clarify the process for players as they are searching for traps.

Time to Check for Traps. Checking for traps is a methodical and time-consuming process. As a rule of thumb, inspecting a 10-foot section of a hallway, room, or single object (such as a chest or door) should take about 1 minute of in-game time. This time increases with the complexity and size of the area or object being inspected. If players wish to check an entire room, use the room's size to determine how long it takes (e.g., a 20-foot-square room would take approximately 4 minutes).

Perception vs. Investigation. The Wisdom (Perception) skill relies on a character's senses. Use Perception when characters might notice something without direct interaction, such as the outline of a secret door or a tripwire. The Intelligence (Investigation) skill is more active and codifies the character's reasoning and deduction. Use Investigation when characters interact with their environment to deduce the presence of traps, such as testing floor tiles for pressure sensitivity or probing a wall for hidden switches.

Passive Checks. Take note of each character's passive Perception score to facilitate the detection of visual traps and secret doors. A passive check made with advantage gains a +5 bonus and one that is made with disadvantage has a -5 penalty.

Disarming Traps. Disarming traps is a method of removing a threat but comes at a risk of triggering the trap. Unless otherwise noted, disarming traps require thieves' tools. A failure on a Dexterity check using thieves' tools of 5 or more below the DC triggers the trap in question.

Sculptures. Persistent bas-reliefs within the labyrinth form an intricate pattern of grooves meant to embody a spiritual map for Lorlana's servants. Monks would focus on these markings during their meditative walks. At times the walls depict divine beings and messengers carrying scrolls or books, or whispering into one another's ears.

AREA 1-1 – BRIDGE OVER OBLIVION

The cavern stretches upward to a 30-foot-high ceiling marked by stalactites, its width reaching a span of nearly 80 feet. A 100-foot-long chasm cleaves the space in two. Suspended by sturdy wires anchored to the ceiling, an iron bridge offers a pathway across the gaping divide. Gazing into the chasm below, a bottomless void of darkness looms. On the opposite side, a pair of stone statues flank a staircase descending into darkness.

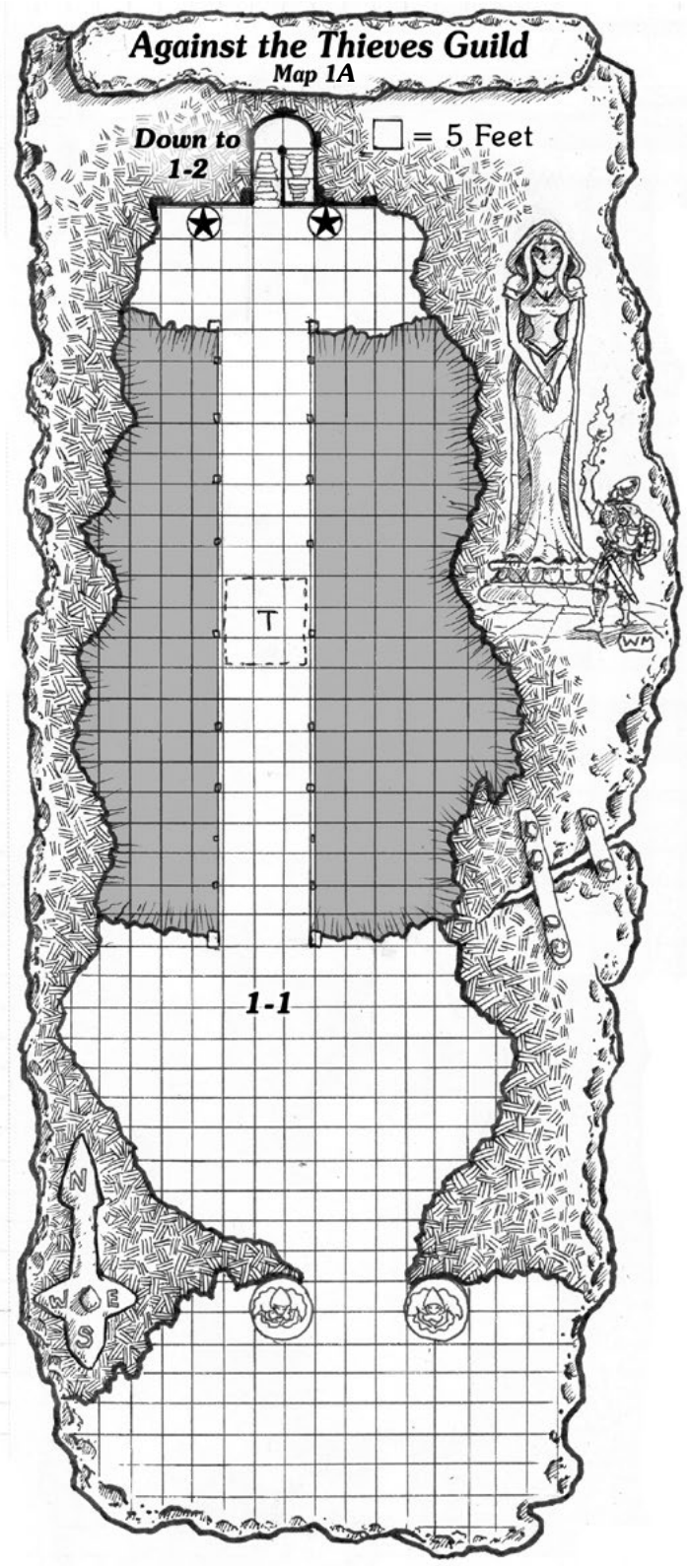
This first challenge Lyria placed to tease her former friend, though it was easily bypassed by Dara when she arrived decades ago. Characters inspecting the cavern walls to the south of the chasm who succeed on a DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) check discover small indentations on one of the walls. These marks were made by pitons Dara used to scale the cavern wall across the chasm, bypassing the bridge. A climber's kit or similar gear may be used to scale the wall. Doing so requires three successful DC 15 Strength checks. Characters who discover and intentionally use the already present piton holes gain advantage on these checks. Failing a check by less than 5 results in no forward progress; a failure of more than 5 causes the character to plummet into the darkness and be teleported inside one of the sectioning chambers in area 1-2 (GM's choice or determine randomly).

A character searching the cavernous ground near the bridge who succeeds on a DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check finds a symbol of an upside-down triangle with two X's intersecting it. A character who understands thieves' cant deciphers it as a warning the area ahead is trapped. The second X implies it is advised to turn away.

Detection. At the middle of the iron bridge is a concealed, 15-foot-square pressure plate spotted with a DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check.

Trigger. A creature stepping on the pressure plate triggers the trap. The bridge begins to fold into a cage. Roll for initiative. The cage is formed on initiative 10. Any characters on the bridge before this occurs can attempt to jump off the bridge (if near the edge) or scramble to the outside of the cage with a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check (player choice).

Effect. If stepped upon, the section of the bridge around the pressure plate remains stationary as the rest of the bridge



folds and closes in upon it, creating a cubic cage, 15 feet on a side, suspended from the ceiling. When this happens, a *magic mouth* spell triggers and appears upon the space of the pressure plate, delivering in Lyria's voice: "You aren't Dara. The trials ahead are beyond your capabilities. Sadly, your fate is to wither in this cage, forgotten and alone."

When the trap is activated, the moving of the wires and general disturbance in the cavern aggravates 15 **stirges** quietly roosting within small crevices in the ceiling. They are instinctually drawn to whatever prey is stuck within the cage. The stirges are Tiny and can squeeze through the cage bars using 10 feet of movement.

Countermeasures. After the trap has been sprung and trapped any of the characters who were standing on the bridge, it's possible to break out of the cage. The metal bars are AC 19 and have 20 hit points. A character succeeding on a DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check can bend the bars enough to allow a Medium creature to slip through.

Reset. A lever on the opposite side of the chasm can be pulled to return the cage back into a bridge.

Characters within the cage can shift their weight and attempt to swing the cage to one of the ledges on either side of the chasm. A creature choosing to time their leap and safely land on the other side must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check. On a success they safely leap to the landing where the bridge originated. On a failure, they plummet into the void below and are teleported inside one of the sectioning chambers in area 1-2 (GM's choice or determine randomly).

AREA 1-2 – SECTIONING CORRIDOR

The stairs lead down to a stretch of corridor, 60 feet long and 5 feet wide. The floor is strewn with bones. A stone door at the end of the hall bears a symbol with three interlocking rings surrounding a pair of closed lips.

GM Note: Area 1-2A on map 2 shows the room before the trap is activated. Area 1-2B on map 1B shows the room after the trap is activated.

Detection. Characters succeeding on a DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check spot seams along the walls, indicating they can open. A successful DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) check finds the pressure plate which is marked "T" on the map.

Trigger. A creature stepping on the pressure plate triggers the trap.

Effect. The shifting walls rotate counterclockwise, becoming perpendicular with the corridor and dividing the hallway into five sections. A creature in one of the middle three sections can attempt a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw to leap into an adjacent section of its choice before the hallway seals.

Four **crawling claws** (12 in total) await any characters trapped within each sectioning chamber. These reanimated hands belonged to members of the Gravelight Soror-

ity who perished in the dungeon's traps. They behave with impudence initially, patting the trapped character sympathetically on the head, making crude gestures, attempting to tickle the victim, etc. After they have had a bit of fun humiliating a trapped character, they attack.

Countermeasures. The pressure plate can be removed and disabled with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. The swiveling walls can be pushed open or shut with a successful DC 18 Strength check.

Reset. The pressure plate takes 30 seconds to reset, after which stepping on it again allows the walls to rotate.

When a character reaches the stone door at the northern end of the hallway, a *magic mouth* spell triggers and the lips within the door's symbol animate and speak: "Steal my pride, Dara? You merely borrowed delusion. To the right, fall victim to what you are. To the left, face your deepest fear."

Treasure. A character searching the middle sectioning chamber who succeeds on a DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check notices a treasure tucked away amongst the remnants of bones belonging to a previous delver. This polished sphere, unblemished by time, is made from glassy obsidian and functions as a *stone of good luck (luckstone)*.

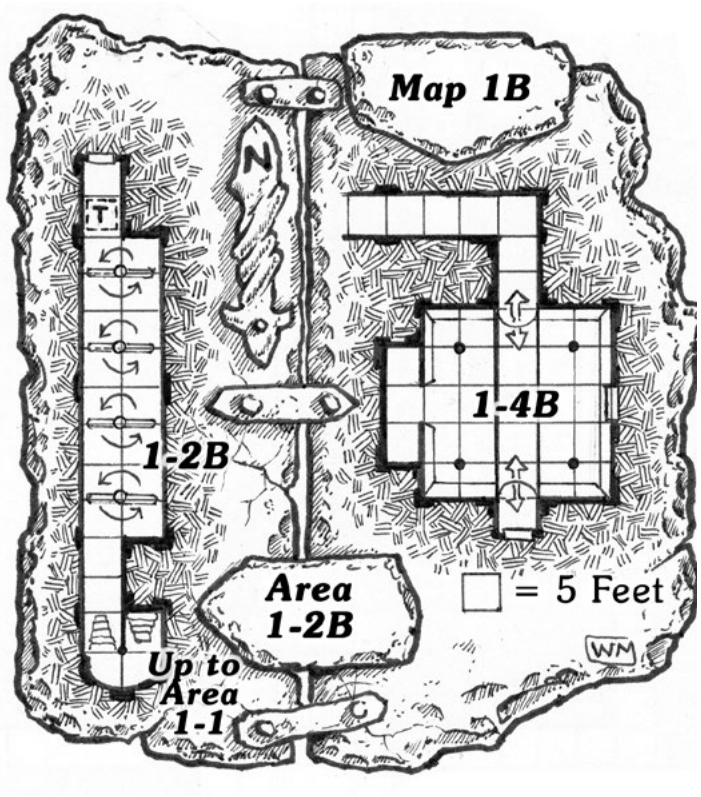
AREA 1-3 – GALLERY OF MIMICS

This chamber, hewn from dark, smooth stone, is dimly lit by ghostly flames flickering in wall sconces. Standing on upraised plinths around the room are four treasure chests, each artfully crafted to resemble monstrous visages with toothy maws and eyes. The lid to each treasure chest is open, each bearing a simple platinum key. At the western side of the chamber, two statues of robed monastic figures stand on pedestals in solemn prayer.

This chamber reflects Lyria's desire to psychologically torment Dara, who held a deep fear of mimics. While none of the treasure chests in the room are truly mimics, they are all trapped.

Secret Door. A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check spots a concealed keyhole in the stonework of the wall between the two statues. Opening the door without the key takes 10 minutes and a successful DC 20 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. Attempting to open the door without the key triggers an attack from two **mimics** disguised as the statues using their False Appearance trait.

Keys. Each key fits the lock of the chest it is found in, allowing the chests to be locked or unlocked. An inspection of the keys, with a successful DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) check, reveals they can be combined to create a master key, capable of opening the secret door.



Trapped Chests. A successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check discerns the razor-sharp lid of each treasure chest is rigged to snap shut if the key it contains is not lifted out of it carefully. The key can be swapped with a similar-sized object by a character succeeding on a DC 14 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check. On a success, they lift the key without activating this trap. A successful DC 17 Dexterity check using thieves' tools disarms the trap. An unsuccessful attempt at disarming this trap triggers its effect. The treasure chest makes a melee attack with a +8 bonus against a target within 5 feet. A target that is hit takes 7 (2d6) piercing damage and is grappled by the trapped chest. A creature can use its action to make a DC 13 Strength check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Each failed check deals 2 (1d4) piercing damage to the trapped creature.

Second Trap. Each chest is equipped with a secondary trap. A character inspecting the inside of a trapped chest who succeeds on a DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals a secret compartment within the chest's lid is filled with liquid designed to spray via a concealed mechanism. This trap does not function if the chest is locked, either by the key taken from inside it or by a character making a DC 17 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. The trap triggers when the secret door is opened. When triggered, anyone within a 10-foot radius of a trapped chest must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or be doused in the incandescent, magical substance. Any weapons, armor, or items

being carried by the character who fails this save begin to radiate a rose-colored light which has the same effect as *faerie fire*. The effect lasts indefinitely but can be canceled via a *dispel magic* spell or similar magic. Cleaning the items of the ink does not eliminate the effect.

AREA 1-4 – RAT TRAP

A rank stench of sewage and animal filth pervades this area. The corridor opens into a larger chamber which is recessed into a 20-foot-deep pit. At its bottom, a greasy black muck covers the floor. Rising from the accumulation of waste are four simple granite pillars ascending to the ceiling. On the eastern side of the pit stands an iron door etched with a symbol of rings closed around shut lips.

Across from where you stand, an opening in the wall directly opposite the corridor seems to continue although there is no floor to connect the two hallways. Between these two archways, recessed into the ceiling directly above is a 5-foot-wide pipe.

GM Note: Area 1-4A on map 2 shows the room before the trap is activated. Area 1-4B on map 1B shows the room after the trap is activated.

This chamber reflects Lyria and Dara's time spent within city sewers during their tenure as footpads for the Gravelight Sorority before they rose up through the ranks. Lyria transformed this chamber into a complex trap to communicate her disdain for Dara as nothing more than a treacherous rat. The floor and ceiling of this pit chamber are designed to descend like a large dumbwaiter when the weight of a delver reaches the bottom.

Detection. A character examining the stone pillars with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check notices they don't support the ceiling. Instead, they appear to act as guide rails, extending upward through narrow openings in the ceiling.

Trigger. The weight of 100 pounds or more on the floor of the pit causes the room's traps to be set into motion.

Effect. Weight upon the pit chamber's floor causes the floor and ceiling to descend 10 feet. The walls of the chamber do not move. It takes 1 round for the chamber to complete its descent. This may result in a split party in which some characters are trapped within the lowered chamber while others are still in the corridor above. The implications for the delvers in the pit chamber are as follows:

- **Hell Cat Released:** An opening in the western wall releases a vicious **hell cat** (see appendix B) that attacks any intruders in the pit chamber. When reduced to 0 hit points, the hell cat disintegrates into a pile of ash.
- **Flammable Sewage:** The slimy black sludge at the bottom of the chamber counts as difficult terrain. The sludge is also flammable; if the floor of the pit chamber comes into contact with flame (such as the hell cat's Fire Breath) it ignites and burns for 2 rounds and deals 5 fire damage to any creature entering or ending its turn in the area.
- **Mouse Trap Door:** The iron door set in the eastern wall is now more difficult to reach as it is now 10 feet from the bottom of the chamber. A character wishing to climb up the wall to reach the door must succeed on a DC 14 Strength (Athletics) check. The door is trapped, which can be discerned with a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) check. Disarming the trap requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. The trap activates upon an attempt to open the door, causing it to swing down from concealed hinges at its base to press the opener against the wall. A successful DC 13 Dexterity saving throw is required to avoid taking 9 (2d8) bludgeoning damage and becoming restrained. On a successful save, the character takes half damage and is not restrained.

Delvers who are not within the pit chamber when it descends experience a different set of circumstances:

- **Secret Passage:** The pipe within the ceiling drops to form a 5-foot-wide corridor between the northern passageway and a secret door revealed to the south.
- **Rat's Nest:** Within the pipe is a nest of diseased rats. They scurry forth and attack. The diseased rats have the statistics of a **swarm of rats**. The rats are also infested with plague and any character starting their turn in the same space as the rats must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become infected with rattlebane (see sidebar).

Countermeasures. Adventurers could attempt to scale the walls horizontally without touching the floor. Doing so requires a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check. The threat of the hell cat would be diminished by burning away the flammable waste by dropping a torch or other source of flame. Another option for bypassing this room would be to drop 100 pounds of objects into the chamber to cause it to descend and gain access to the secret corridor.

Reset. A concealed button disguised as a part of the stone wall can be found by a succeeding on a DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check in the northern passageway leading to the chamber. Pressing the button resets the chamber to its starting position if the floor holds less than 100 pounds of weight.

AREA 1-5 – ROLLING STONE

This dark hallway is choked with cobwebs and dust. Bas-reliefs along the walls depict silent figures shrouded in cloaks carrying candles.

After at least one character moves 20 feet into the hallway, continue:

As you progress forward, you spot an enormous stone boulder rolling down the corridor in your direction.

This trap relies on a magical illusion designed to trick the characters into falling into the very real harm of poisoned needles sticking out of the walls.

Detection. A successful DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals the boulder is rolling through the center of the hall and has enough clearance on the sides for characters standing flat against the walls to avoid impact. A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check also reveals the walls are covered in half-inch needles. A character inspecting the boulder or wall determines it is an illusion with a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check.

Trigger. The magical illusion of the boulder is triggered by walking 20 feet into the corridor.

Effect. Any creature not wearing heavy armor that chooses to press flat against a wall to avoid the boulder must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failure save, the creature takes 11 (2d10) poison damage and is poisoned for 1 hour. On a success, the creature takes half as much damage and is not poisoned. A character standing in the path of the boulder takes no damage as the illusory stone vanishes upon impact.

Countermeasures. A character who declares they are using an item such as a thick blanket or bedroll to create a buffer between their body and the spikes gains advantage on their saving throw, as fewer needles contact their skin.

Reset. After the illusion has been activated it is unable to do so again until 10 minutes have passed.

AREA 1-6 – CEILING TRAP

The corridor opens into a chamber measuring 25 feet by 35 feet. On the east and west walls are sturdy wooden doors reinforced with iron bands. Near the southern end of the room stands a life-sized statue carved from dark marble. The statue depicts a robed monastic figure, its face serene yet featureless. In its outstretched hands, it holds a gleaming rapier.

Both doors are trapped and open outward. Inspecting a door with a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals opening it triggers a trap. Disabling a trap requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. Failure by 5 or more triggers the trap as if that door had been opened.

East Door. When the east door is opened, the ceiling area between the doors in the middle of the room slams down to the floor (the unshaded area on the map). Characters in the space when this occurs must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, they take 42 (12d6) bludgeoning damage. On a success, they take half as much damage. The ceiling retracts to its original position after 2 rounds.

West Door. When the west door is opened, the ceiling areas on the north and south sides of the room slam down to the floor (the shaded area on the map). Any creatures in the area suffer the same effect as the east door above. The statue at the southern end of the room is crushed into a pile of rubble, though the magical sword is unharmed.

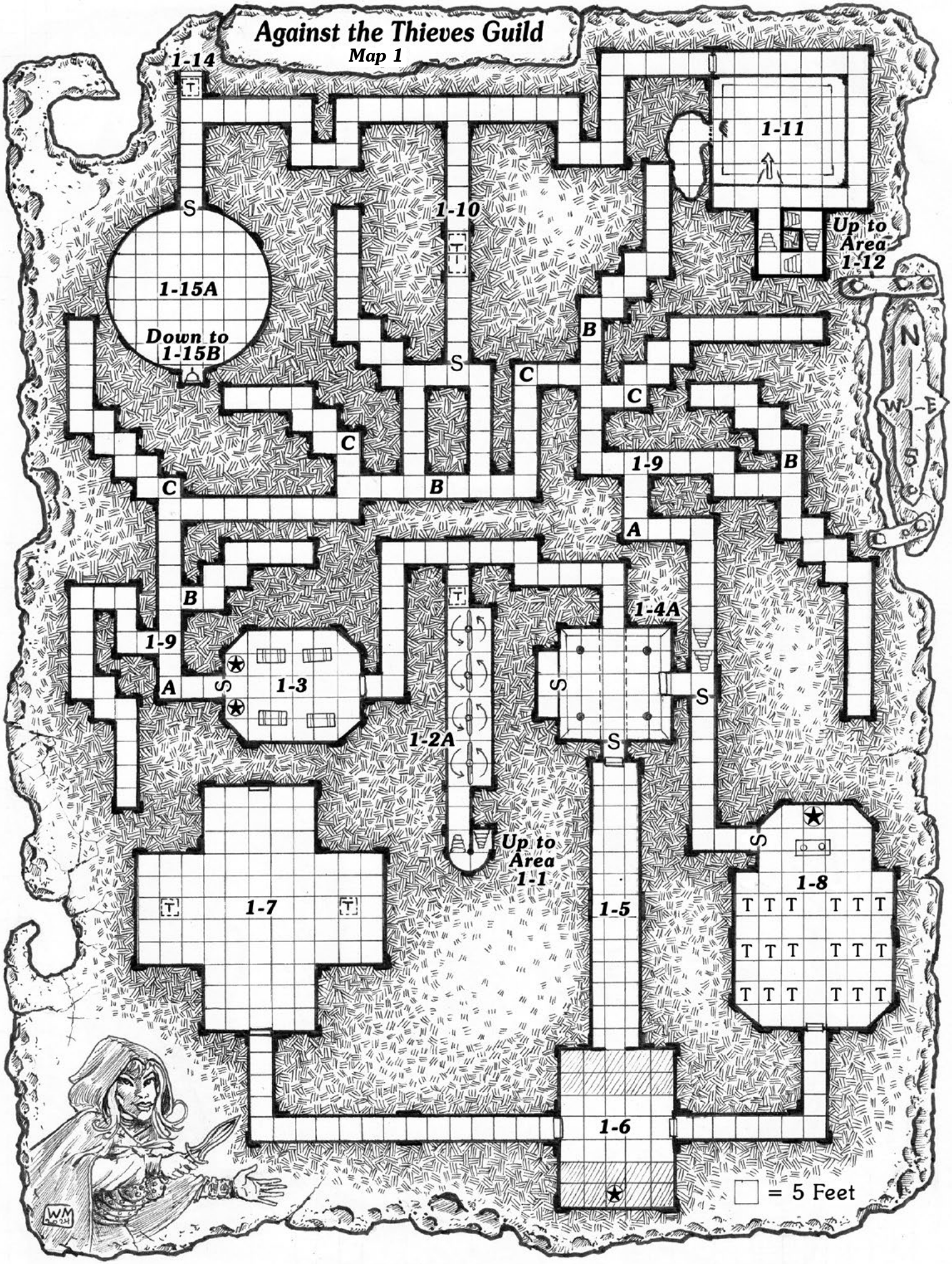
Sword of the Silent Sentinel. The sword is a *+2 rapier* which belonged to Dara and has been rigged with a trap. Characters closely examining the sword and succeeding on a DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) check discover a hidden hinge in the hilt. Disabling this trap requires a successful DC 17 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. Once disarmed, it functions as a typical *+2 rapier*.

While the trap is active and the sword is used in combat, the spring-loaded hinge activates and the blade swings forward on its hinge, cutting through the guard and slicing the wielder's hand. The wielder must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, the wielder takes 13 (3d8) slashing damage and loses 2 (1d4) fingers. All Dexterity

Rattlebane

This disease is often carried among vermin and is a feared affliction by many professional thieves. Rattlebane causes the plagued victim to experience intermittent muscle spasms and uncontrollable shaking, primarily in the extremities. When a creature comes in contact with a source of contamination, they must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become infected.

Symptoms are rapid and manifest within 10 minutes of infection. An infected creature has disadvantage on Dexterity checks and saving throws. At the end of a long rest, an infected creature succeeding on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw recovers from the disease. The effect can also be removed by *lesser restoration* or similar magic.


Against the Thieves Guild
Map 1
1-14
1-11
1-10
1-15A
Down to 1-15B
Up to Area 1-12
1-9
1-4A
1-3
1-2A
1-7
1-5
1-8
1-6
Up to Area 1-1
N
W
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= 5 Feet

checks using that hand are made at disadvantage unless the fingers are restored via a *regenerate* or *wish* spell. On a success, the character takes half damage and manages to drop the blade before losing any fingers.

Treasure. If the statue is crushed by the ceiling trap, a treasure previously concealed within the monument is revealed. Among the stone debris is a small iron box holding a *gem of seeing*.

AREA 1-7 – BLACK PARLOR

Four ghastly purple orbs drift through this chamber, bathing it in a dim, somber radiance. The room is carved entirely from dark, polished marble. To the east and west, meticulously arranged pyramids of skulls encircle ornate treasure chests. A stately mirror rests against the far wall, its frame crafted in elegant detail with a repeating pattern of roses.

This room was a reading room but after Lyria's occupation of the labyrinth it became an oubliette where she keeps her victims, both the alive and deceased.

Holes in Wall. Concealed holes in the walls can be discovered by a character searching the walls with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check.

Piles of Skulls. These skulls are the remains of Lyria's victims, serving as her trophies.

Balanced Treasure Chest Trap. Both treasure chests are filled to the top with an equal weight of skulls. An observant character succeeding on a DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check notices the glint of metal at the bottom of a chest, hinting at treasures beneath.

Both chests are perfectly weighed to the other and rest upon fully concealed pressure plates. The trap is activated when the weight difference between the two chests is more than 5 pounds. A character succeeding on a DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) check identifies the presence of the pressure plates. On a failure of 5 or more, they set off the trap.

When triggered, the door to the chamber slams shut and the floor pivots sharply from its center up to 45 degrees toward the heaviest point in the room, which depending on where characters are standing could be north, east, south, or west. Any creature standing in the room when the trap is triggered must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw or be thrown prone and begin sliding down the incline. The section of chamber at the bottom of the incline descends 5 feet into a pool of green slime below the room which filters in via the holes in the wall. Any character who failed their saving throw falls into contact with the slime and takes 5 (1d10) acid damage. The creature takes the



damage again at the start of each of its turns until the slime is scraped off or destroyed. Against wood or metal, green slime deals 11 (2d10) acid damage each round, and any nonmagical wood or metal weapon or tool used to scrape off the slime is effectively destroyed.

While the chamber is tilted, any movement towards the center of the room can cause an extreme shift which sends the characters tumbling to another section of the chamber. A character attempting to move up the incline without causing a dramatic shift must make a DC 13 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check. On a failure, all characters in the chamber must make another saving throw or potentially fall to the opposite side of the room and slide into the slime.

To reestablish balance the characters must position themselves relatively evenly around the room and place two objects of equal weight on the pressure plates. This causes the floor to lock in place once again.

Mirror of Life Trapping. The mirror on the northern wall is a *mirror of life trapping*. If the room's trap is activated, the mirror falls from the wall and shatters, releasing its inhabitants. The six female **spies** are all (former) members of the Gravelight Sorority who came to the labyrinth to take

back the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* from Lyria. Mistaking the characters for another of Lyria's cruel games, they prepare to defend themselves fiercely. A character succeeding on a DC 15 Charisma (Intimidation or Persuasion) check can convince them to cease their attack. If befriended, they share the information in the background of the adventure regarding Lyria and Dara's relationship and the Gravelight Sorority. Under no circumstances do they join the characters in delving deeper into the trap-filled tomb; having gained their freedom they are eager to leave with their lives intact.

Treasure. The bottom of each treasure chest contains a *+1 dagger* and five black opals worth 500 gp each.

AREA 1-8 – SILENT SANCTUM

A pervasive and unnatural silence fills the space of this chamber. Vaulted ceilings loom overhead, adorned with faded frescoes of cowled figures whispering to one another. Old prayer mats line the stone hall; next to each lies a skeleton. At the northern end of the sanctum is an altar, behind which stands a large ornate statue of a woman wearing a scarf with a finger pressed to her lips.

This hall of prayer and worship was trapped by Lyria to slay the monastics after she finished using their labor to build her initial traps.

Unnatural Silence. The chamber has a permanent *silence* spell placed upon it.

Prayer Mats. Each prayer mat is pierced by a 1-inch hole, a detail serving as a clue to the trap that killed the monastics who were praying here. A character who searches the stonework underneath the mats with a successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check finds concealed holes housing spears. The skeletons of the deceased lie nearby in their tattered robes.

Statue of Lorlana. A character searching the statue and succeeding on a DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) check notices the hand of the statue is a lever. Moving the lever to the right appears to do nothing, but it releases an odorless gas that fills the chamber over the course of the next 10 minutes (the sound of the gas jets cannot be heard because of the *silence* spell). Characters who spend the full 10 minutes within this area must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become paralyzed for 1 hour. After 15 minutes, spears shoot up from underneath where the prayer mats are placed. When the trap is triggered, each spear targets a creature standing on a trapped floor section, with a +8 bonus to hit and dealing 11 (2d10) piercing damage.

If the hand is turned to the left, the secret door at the northern end of the room slides open, leading back to the labyrinth.

Altar. Upon the altar are a bronze bowl, incense, and small strips of parchment paper. A character who searches the altar and succeeds on a DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check finds an inscription: "Only an offering to Lorlana allows you keep what you bequeath." If a character pens a secret or a piece of knowledge few know about on the parchment and burns it in the bowl with the incense, a ring materializes on the statue of Lorlana's hand and drops to the floor. This is a *ring of mind shielding*.

Development. The soul of the head monastic resides within the ring and begins to communicate telepathically with any character who wears the ring. Introducing herself simply as Sister Abbess (members of the order of Lorlana forsake their identities after devoting themselves to their spiritual path), she shares the history of the order's downfall, the theft and return of the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*, and the betrayal they endured by trusting the thief, Lyria. The Sister Abbess directs the character to obtain the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* so it can be taken from the hands of a heathen and restored. The Sister Abbess mistakenly believes the holy artifact is still located in area 1-13.

AREA 1-9 – LABYRINTH

The stonework in these halls features a sophisticated network of interlacing grooves forming an unbroken, flowing design stretching the length of the hallway. Bas-reliefs line the top of the corridor's décor, depicting rows of monastic faces leering down to gaze at passersby. Statuettes of young street urchins hold candles within recesses placed in the walls providing dim, flickering light throughout the passage.

The labyrinth has numerous locations, as described below.

A. Moving Stone Block. After the characters pass by either of the areas marked "A" on the map, an **animated stone block** (see appendix B) rises from the floor. The block is 4 feet wide, 4 feet long, and 8 feet tall. Once active, the block and the characters roll initiative. The block follows the characters through the corridor but stops short of crushing the characters, slowing its movement to a negligible pace once it comes to within 10 feet of a dead-end corridor. Characters who enter a corridor where there is a dead end may become fearful of getting crushed to death by the block and attempt to push back against it. The block discharges its Spike Trap ability 1 round after it halts its movement. Any creature actively pushing against the block has disadvantage on their Dexterity saving throw.

After the block discharges its trap, a *magic mouth* appears on its stonework and Lyria's voice speaks: "These walls have been Lorlana's ears. Now I've given them teeth. I've been going easy on you—that won't last much longer." The block then withdraws and returns to its original position, blocking the passage for 30 minutes before descending back into the floor.

B. Pits. Throughout the labyrinth (marked "B" on the map) are open, 5-foot-wide pits in the floor which have pressure plates at their bottoms. The adventurers may be tempted to lead a moving animated stone block to one of these openings to ditch it. Doing so causes the block to slide down into the pit, activating the pressure plate. This triggers the mouths on bas-relief faces throughout the labyrinth's walls to dispense a cloudy, sulfurous-smelling gas. The cloudy vapor makes visibility difficult, imposing disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks to spot floor traps.

The lit candles within the hall signal the gas's combustibility by flickering more intensely. It takes 20 minutes for the gas to become dense enough to be explosive. Once it reaches this critical level, any spark can set off an explosion erupting throughout the corridors. Everyone in area 1-9 when this occurs must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. A creature suffers 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

C. Fire Bolt Trap. Each of the areas marked "C" on the map contains a tripwire which is spotted with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. When tripped, two *fire bolt* spells are discharged from the eyes of a bas-relief face from the opposing wall. Each targets the individual tripping the trap with a +5 on the attack roll, dealing 5 (1d10) fire damage on a hit. If the corridors have filled with explosive gas over the course of 20 minutes, the *fire bolts* trigger the explosion described above.

Secret Door. The secret door leading to area 1-10 is detectable with a successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check. Finding the switch that opens it requires successful a DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) check while searching the southern wall opposite the secret door.

AREA 1-10 – TRIPWIRE THAT ISN'T

On either side of a 10-foot-long section of floor within this corridor is an obvious pair of tripwires set 10 feet apart from each other.

Detection. Characters automatically spot each tripwire 18 inches above the floor. Upon closer inspection, a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check allows a character to identify an unnatural crack in the floor on the other side of the tripwire (i.e., between the wires).

Trigger. The trap activates if any size Small or larger creature stands on the hinged section of floor beyond either tripwire.

Effect. There is a 40-foot-deep pit below the hinged section of floor. A character slowly stepping onto the hinged section of floor must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw to step back before falling in. A character leaping over a tripwire does not get to make a save. A character who falls takes 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage. A successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check is required to climb out of the pit.

If the trap is triggered, a *magic mouth* spell appears on the wall within the pit and goads the victim: "Careful, the floor here will betray you. Perhaps it took a lesson from you, Dara. If you are still breathing, make haste—your reward awaits."

Countermeasures. Breaking a tripwire locks the floor section in place, disabling the trap. The floor section can be secured in place with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. A character who jumps to the middle of the floor section can attempt to balance on the fulcrum point. They achieve this with a successful DC 15 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check; on a failure they fall into the pit.

Reset. If a tripwire is broken, the trap requires a manual reset. Otherwise, the trap resets when the trapped floor stops spinning after 1 minute.

AREA 1-11 – PERDITION'S PRISON

A narrow, 5-foot-wide walkway edges around a deep pit filled with bones and detritus, 40 feet below. Across the pit, the path leads to an archway with an ascending spiral staircase beyond. From the shadows below a ghastly figure moves into view: a woman with bone-white hair and eyes that glow red with undying fury.

The walls of the pit are composed of smooth stone requiring incredible strength to climb without magic or climbing gear. A character succeeding on a DC 23 Strength check could achieve such a feat.

The creature is **Dara**, **accursed master thief** (see appendix C), who ousted Lyria as leader of the Gravelight Sorority thieves' guild. After sending many agents to pursue the retrieval of the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*, Dara took it upon herself to try and reclaim their treasure. She failed and perished during a confrontation with the trap golem in area 1-13. After her death, Lyria took efforts to reanimate her as an intelligent undead wretch so Lyria could continue to torment her. Dara remains trapped in this pit, fantasizing about the day she may get vengeance.

Dara asks to be released from the pit and demands the characters throw her down a rope. She makes it clear her goal is



retribution against Lyria. If the characters refuse, she curses them and vows to hunt them down when she gets her freedom. If the characters begin attacking Dara from the high ground, she scuttles out of sight into a small crevice in the western wall she's claimed as her den.

At the top of the stairs is a wooden door. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals that opening the door is the trigger for a trap. A character succeeding on a DC 17 Dexterity check with thieves' tools can disable the trap and allow the door to be opened normally. If the trap is triggered, a trapdoor at the top of the staircase opens and the victim falls through a winding chute and drops down into the pit. If Dara's attitude is antagonistic towards the party, she attacks.

Treasure. Dara is wearing a *cape of Dorian Grey* (see appendix A) she found elsewhere in the dungeon. Dara did not live long enough after acquiring it to know it is cursed.

AREA 1-12 – TRAPPED ANTECHAMBER

An elongated hallway stretches 10 feet in width and 40 feet in length. The walls are devoid of the familiar pattern of design seen elsewhere on the dungeon level. At the far end, a pair of formidable bronze double doors stand closed.

This hall is trapped. A giant crossbow pointed toward the ceiling is hidden beneath a 10-foot section of the corridor. When that section is stepped on, the crossbow fires upward, wedging victims between its quarrel and the ceiling, 20 feet above. After it discharges, a shaft in the floor exposes a chamber where the crossbow mechanism is held. Shortly after being activated, a volley of normal sized crossbow bolts fires from hidden compartments in the walls of the shaft at creatures within the corridor.

Features. This trap has two main features: the Giant Crossbow and the Twelve Hidden Cranequins.

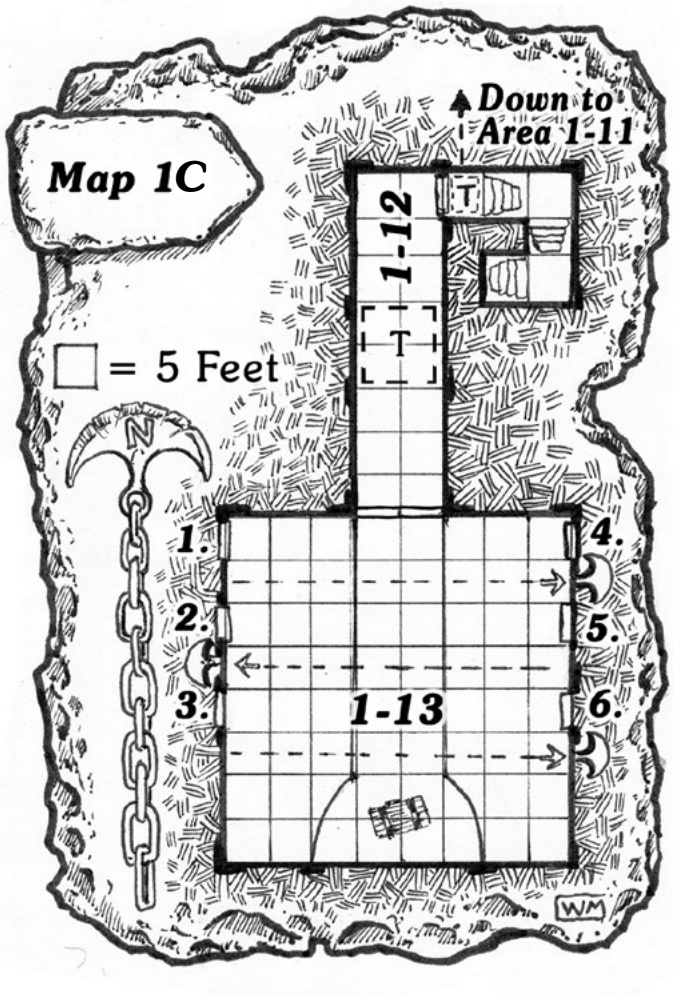
Detection. A successful DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals a 10-foot section of the corridor's floor isn't flush with the rest of the stonework.

Trigger. The trap is activated when one or more creatures weighing at least 50 pounds step on the 10-foot section of pressure-sensitive floor.

Effects:

- **Giant Crossbow (Reaction, Once).** The 10-foot section of the floor launches upward, and each creature standing on it must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage and become restrained as it is pinned between the trap and the ceiling. A creature succeeding on its saving throw takes half as much damage and can leap to either side of the now-open section of the floor. A creature restrained by the trap can use an action to attempt a DC 15 Strength or Dexterity check to free itself. A creature failing to free itself takes 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage at the end of each of its turns while restrained.
- **Twelve Hidden Cranequins (Initiative 10, 3 Charges).** Twelve crossbows hidden within the now-exposed hole in the floor fire upward. The cranequins make one attack roll against each creature within 15 feet of the opening. Each attack has a +8 bonus to hit and deals 10 (1d10 + 5) piercing damage on a hit. This attack roll can't be made at advantage or disadvantage.

Countermeasures. A combined weight of at least 1,000 pounds on the trapped floor weighs down the mechanism



and prevents it from firing. Once it has fired, the oversized crossbow bolt can be pulled from the ceiling with a successful DC 22 Strength check. In the chamber below, the bolt can be cranked back down with two consecutive successful DC 13 Strength checks.

Reset. This trap's components require a manual reset.

Vault Doors. A *glyph of warding* on the double doors triggers if either door is opened, casting *thunderwave* (save DC 15, 9 [2d8] thunder damage). Note the spell's 15-foot-cube area of affect; a victim who fails the saving throw is pushed 10 feet and may activate the crossbow trap.

AREA 1-13 – FALSE RELIQUARY VAULT

Past the threshold, a 10-foot-wide bridge stretches across this vaulted chamber to a raised platform at the far end. On the platform is a brass treasure chest, ornately decorated with intricate gold and silver designs detailing roses shedding their petals embossed into its surface. A mosaic on the wall behind the treasure chest features a feminine face with eyes and ears but conspicuously lacking a mouth. On either side of the walkway, the room drops off into a pit teeming with countless writhing serpents nesting within. Set into the east and west walls across the chasm are six stone doors.

This chamber served as the vault for the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* prior to Dara and Lyria's initial acquisition. Lyria has become afflicted with the curse of the artifact; she has taken it down to Level 2 intent to unlock its secrets.

As the characters enter the room, a *magic mouth* appears on the mosaic speaking, "Sorry, the reliquary is not here—its true location you shall never find. Farewell, Dara. Know that I gave you all my love and hate." The platform the treasure chest rests on rises and reveals itself to be the head of a **trap golem** (see appendix B) which prepares to attack.

Illusory Floor. The pit of snakes is an illusion intended to keep delvers on the bridge or make them retreat to area 1-12 and put them at risk of tripping the crossbow trap if it is still active. A character interacting with the floor or who takes an action to study it and succeeds on a DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check determines its illusory nature.

Swinging Scythes. There are three swinging scythes hidden in the walls that can be released by the trap golem using its Activate Trap legendary action. Each scythe requires a separate legendary action to trigger. Once triggered, a scythe is released and swings outward from a hanging chain across the room. When triggered, a scythe moves across the room with a speed of 40 feet. The scythe trap makes an attack against any creature in its path as it swings across the room. The attacks have a +7 to hit and deal 5 (1d10) slashing damage on a hit. After being triggered, the scythe makes subsequent attacks on initiative count 10.

A character succeeding on a DC 15 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check can leap onto a scythe and grab hold of its chain, providing an advantageous position against the trap golem.

Trapped Doors. Behind each of the six doors is a different statue which deploys a one-time simple trap when opened. Each door can be opened by the trap golem using its Activate Trap legendary action. Each door and its effect are as follows:

Door	Statue	Effect
1	Soldier	The statue throws a spear it is holding at a living target within 30 feet. Ranged attack, +6 to hit, 9 (2d8) piercing damage on a hit.
2	Wizard	The statue's finger dispenses an arc of lightning directly east in a 30-foot line that is 5 feet wide. Each creature in that area must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) lightning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

3	Medusa	Each creature within 30 feet that can see the statue must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature begins to turn to stone and is restrained. The restrained creature must repeat the saving throw at the end of its next turn, becoming petrified on a failure or ending the effect on a success. The petrification lasts until the creature is freed by the *greater restoration* spell or other magic.
4	Black Dragon	A spray of corrosive acid shoots out from the statue's mouth in a 30-foot line that is 5 feet wide. Each creature in that line must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 9 (2d8) acid damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.
5	Yeti	A frigid gust of air issues forth from the statue's mouth, targeting a 10-foot square centered on the bridge directly west of the door. Each creature in that area must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw, taking 13 (3d8) cold damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The ground within this area is covered in slippery ice that remains for 1 minute and becomes difficult terrain. A creature that enters the area or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.
6	Hell Hound	The statue's mouth discharges three blasts of flame at up to three different living targets within 30 feet. Ranged attack, +6 to hit, 5 (1d10) fire damage on a hit.

Treasure. Within the chest is a single gold coin etched with a stylized "L" on one side and a "D" on the other. This coin was responsible for making decisions between Lyria and Dara whilst they were still comrades during their heists together. Accompanying the coin is a letter scrawled on paper intended for Dara. Provide **player handout 1**.

AREA 1-14 – DOUBLE TRAP

Stepping into this hall, you see a massive ornate door of bronze, its surface inlaid with the emblematic motif of three interlocking rings encircling a pair of sealed lips. Opposite the door and down the hall, the wall is covered in spikes.

Detection. A character succeeding on a DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check while inspecting the bronze door notices the floor, walls, and ceiling within 15 feet of the door are rough as if scraped by the friction of a large object. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigate) check while inspecting the spiked wall reveals that it does not seem mortared to the rest of the corridor and reveals it as a secret door.

Trigger. The trap is activated if a creature attempts to open the bronze door or sticks anything in its keyhole.

Effect. Any creature within 15 feet of the door when it springs outward must make a DC 16 Strength saving throw, taking 22 (4d10) bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. In addition, a character who fails this saving throw is flung up to 30 feet towards the spiked wall. Creatures pushed towards the spiked wall must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw, taking 33 (6d10) piercing damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The force of a creature falling into the wall is enough to collapse the spiked wall, revealing a secret passage behind it.

AREA 1-15 – ROLLING TO THEIR DEPTHS

In the center of this circular chamber stands a towering column of smooth stone, its surface carved with vast grooves which spiral along its length, seamlessly merging with the chamber's floor. On the opposite side of the room on the wall is a lever, currently positioned upward.

GM Note: Prior to the lever being activated, the chamber is depicted as area 1-15A on map 2. After the lever has been activated and the chamber drops, this room is depicted as area 1-15B on map 3.

Previously, this chamber operated as a gradual elevator to transport monks down into Lorlana's treasury where coin and precious gemstones were held. Lyria has since converted it into one of her traps.

The lever controls the room's floor and ceiling. Pushing the lever up or down causes the chamber to rise or descend, respectively, moving like a colossal gear around the central stone pillar. Once activated, the lever locks in place and the chamber rises or descends 100 feet over 18 seconds.

The chamber begins its descent and quickly begins to accelerate. Characters that have not taken precautions such as anchoring themselves to the floor must make a DC 15 Strength saving throw. On a failure, they are flung against the wall and take 17 (5d6) bludgeoning damage. On a success, they manage to cling to the floor as it spins wildly to the second level of the dungeon, taking no damage.

LEVEL 2: THE VAULTS OF SACRED OFFERING

The second level of the dungeon holds the areas of Lorlana's monastery that only the highest ranking of her faithful were allowed to access. Most of these areas were former vaults which held material wealth collected and distributed to individuals who made spiritual offerings to the patron of secrets. Now these halls are filled with traps designed by Lyria to deter adventuring parties from disturbing the former thieves' guild leader while she obsessively studies the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*.

GENERAL FEATURES

Dungeon Level 2 is depicted on map 2.

Corridors and Rooms. Unless otherwise noted, all corridors are 10 feet high, and the walls are constructed of finished granite stone. Ceilings in dungeon rooms are 15 feet high.

Illumination. The entirety of the labyrinth is unlit unless otherwise noted.

Doors. Unless otherwise noted, all doors are made of stone (AC 17, 22 hit points, immunity to poison and psychic damage, resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage).

Obscuring Fog. All areas of Level 2 are covered by an obscuring fog pumped into the halls by jets built deep in the walls, causing affected areas to be lightly obscured. Zimgrazhan's Workshop (area 2-3) and the Reliquary Vault (area 2-10) are unaffected.

AREA 2-1 – HALL OF ONE THOUSAND SLICES

A stone door with a familiar symbol of three interlocking rings surrounding a pair of closed lips precedes this area. When the characters approach it, another *magic mouth* spell is triggered and delivers a message from Lyria: "Congratulations. You survived these traps designed to slaughter the most cunning thieves from my former guild. Leave while you can still make this claim."

After the characters open the door, read, or paraphrase the following:

The walls of this rectangular chamber span 40 feet in length. Seemingly hundreds of gleaming daggers protrude menacingly from the walls on both sides of the hall. Directly aligned down the middle of the floor and ceiling are equally sharp rows of swords which lead up to a stone door on the opposite wall.

Lyria incorporated the blades from her conquered guildmates into this chamber's trap. The characters must find a way to navigate to the opposite side of this chamber to reach the stone door to progress further. The stonework on the ceiling and the walls containing the doors is marked with dozens of triangles missing half a segment on one side with a line through it; this is a thieves' cant symbol which means "not safe for the guild."

Detection. A successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check allows a delver to notice the 10-foot-wide swath of stone floor beside a dagger wall is pitted with stab marks (indicated by the shaded area on the map) while the stonework surrounding the row of swords in the floor is smooth. A character succeeding on a DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check determines the chamber is divided along the row of swords in the floor, into two large sections which are pressure sensitive.

Trigger. Walking more than 10 feet into the room triggers an area of the pressure-activated floor, causing either the left, right, or both dagger walls to fall inward.

Effect. When one of the pressure plates to either side of the row of swords is depressed, the corresponding 40-foot wall (the wall nearest the pressed plate) falls inward towards the floor, threatening any characters with numerous piercing cuts. A character caught by this effect is knocked prone and subjected to eight dagger attacks, each with an attack bonus of +8, dealing 6 (1d4 + 4) piercing damage on a successful hit.

A character who straddles the line of swords down the middle of the room triggers both walls at the same time, which results in the two walls falling at the same time and jamming together. This allows safe passage to the other door.

Reset. A wall automatically resets the round after it falls, if set off individually. If both walls are triggered at the same time, it takes them 5 rounds for their machinery to force them back into position.

AREA 2-2 – PILUM STAIRWAY

The staircase leading down to area 2-3 is rigged with a trap that activates when the pressure plate marked "T" on the map is stepped upon.

The unlit staircase leads downward, thick dust covering its steps. Empty sconces along the wall seem to indicate that at one time torches lined this passage.

When the trap is triggered, a pilum juts out from each riser (the vertical, front face of the step) at three, four, and five steps above the pressure plate. Each pilum is 10 feet in length,

allowing for multiple targets due to the spacing and placement. This trap is particularly effective against parties that do not leave space between characters in the marching order.

Detection. Characters notice a slightly discolored spot on the stairs (the pressure plate) with a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check and can also detect the concealed holes from which the pila emerge with a check result of 19.

Trigger. The trap is sprung when a character steps on the pressure plate.

Effect. Once triggered, the pila jut out from their concealed holes. The character who stepped on the pressure plate and anyone standing up to 10 feet behind them must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw or take 14 (4d6) piercing damage. If struck, roll 1d8 to determine which of the character's body parts is pierced by the pilum, and apply the accompanying effect, which lasts until the character is healed.

d8	Body Part Hit	Effect
1	Dominant Arm	The character has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws requiring the use of their dominant hand.
2	Non-Dominant Arm	The character has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws requiring the use of their non-dominant hand, and shields cannot be held in this hand.
3	Leg	The character's speed is reduced by 10 feet.
4	Abdomen	The character has disadvantage on Constitution saving throws.
5	Chest	The length of time the character can hold their breath is halved.
6	Neck	Due to blood loss, the character continues to lose 1 additional hit point per round.
7	Head	Spellcasters are unable to cast concentration spells and have disadvantage on all Intelligence-based ability checks and saving throws.
8	Eye	The character has disadvantage on ranged attack rolls and Wisdom (Perception) checks.

Countermeasures. Once the pressure plate is detected, it can be removed from the step—which therefore disables the trap—with a successful DC 16 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. The pila could be thwarted by inserting appropriately sized objects or substances into the holes from which they emerge, thus blocking or gumming them up before the spiked poles can jut out.

Reset. The Pilum Pacifier is reset via a removable crank that can be inserted at the top of the stairs that pulls the pila back into the stairs and resets the pressure plate back into the step.

AREA 2-3 – ZIMGRAZHAN'S WORKSHOP

This cluttered chamber is filled with an array of tools and workbenches are arranged haphazardly throughout the space. Iron instruments of curious purpose hang from chains throughout the room just above each workbench. Upon the walls are countless scrolls and parchments detailing the design of devilishly complex traps. The floor is littered with loose springs, gears, and wires—assembly pieces for some yet-to-be designed mechanical trap.

This chamber is the workshop for Lyria's **imp** familiar, Zimgrazhan. Hidden behind the trap schematics is a valve halfway up the wall. The valve is connected to metal tubes running down the wall and exiting through the floor. This valve controls the obscuring mist pervading this level of the dungeon; turning it off makes it easier to navigate and locate traps.

Whenever Zimgrazhan is not patrolling the upper level of the dungeon to repair or install new traps, he can be found here scheming and designing new traps to enhance the labyrinth's defenses. As soon as the characters arrive, Zimgrazhan elects to turn invisible as he interacts with the party.

Zimgrazhan is extremely proud of his traps and takes offense if any comment is made about them being easy to bypass. He fishes for compliments when encountered, by asking the adventuring party if there were more of them when they arrived or to describe the worst injury they sustained.

Zimgrazhan is surprisingly chatty but seems reluctant to discuss his master. A character who succeeds on a DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion) check gets him talking about some specific information:

- Lyria was the former leader of a thieves' guild called the Gravelight Sorority. She was deposed as guildmaster by her partner, Dara.
- Lyria stole and brought the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* to this dungeon of death to bait her former friend and the other members of the thieves' guild into attempting to retrieve it.
- She succeeded in killing off Dara and the Gravelight Sorority but has not left the dungeon. She has become obsessed with the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* and has isolated herself within one of the former vaults with the object.

Zimgrazhan: The Imp Saboteur

The GM may employ Zimgrazhan in several different ways to maximize the dynamics of the dungeon during play. Here are a few suggestions to allow Zimgrazhan to take a more active role in sabotaging the party:

Setting Traps During Rests. While no wandering monsters exist within the dungeon, at the GM's discretion Zimgrazhan may be able to serve a similar function. If the party decides to take a short or long rest, he might seize the opportunity to set up traps in their vicinity using *Zimgrazhan's Toolbox of Trapsmithing* (see appendix A).

Resetting Disabled Traps. Another of Zimgrazhan's tactics is to revisit traps the characters have already disabled and reset them. He takes great care not to make it obvious their preventative measures have been tampered with. For example, he leaves the appearance that pitons under pressure plates are still actively preventing a trap from activating.

Bait-and-Switch. Zimgrazhan is fond of leaving marks or signs along the walls to confuse adventurers, either pointing them in the direction of a trap he has set or towards one innately found within the dungeon. Alternatively, he also possesses a storm gem (see appendix A) used as bait in noticeable locations throughout the dungeon to entice characters to travel in the pathway of one of his traps. Of course, the gem itself is also trapped.

Zimgrazhan's apparent willingness to engage in conversation with the party is a strategic delay tactic as he covertly activates a hidden trap within the room. A character succeeding on a DC 14 Wisdom (Insight) check recognizes he is rephrasing and restating pieces of information unnecessarily.

Features. Discreetly positioned under the high surface of the central workbench is a concealed button. Zimgrazhan activates the button while invisible. In doing so, an odorless, flammable gas slowly begins to fill the chamber from tiny jets installed within the walls.

Detection. Anyone with a passive Wisdom (Perception) score of 15 or higher notices the blueprints and schematics hanging from the walls begin to waver, a clue as to the air currents created by the release of the gas into the room.

Trigger. Pressing the button concealed on the workbench triggers the trap.

Effect. A character standing inside the room for 5 minutes must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned. Also, after 5 minutes have passed, the gas in the chamber becomes concentrated enough for any spark or flame to cause an explosion. Each character in the room when this occurs must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 35 (10d6) fire damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one.

Once Zimgrazhan observes the characters showing symptoms of gas exposure, he slyly reaches for flint and steel from one of the workbenches, intending to ignite the volatile atmosphere. Zimgrazhan remains unscathed due to his immunity to fire damage, and he moves to slip away from the room and escape into the dungeon.

Treasure. Upon one of the workbenches rests *Zimgrazhan's Toolbox of Trapsmithing* (see appendix A). A small brown bag contains a *storm gem* (see appendix A) which Zimgrazhan uses to bait adventurers towards traps.

AREA 2-4 – VAULT ANTECHAMBER

The door into this area is locked. A character succeeding on a DC 18 Dexterity check using thieves' tools can open the lock and enter. When the door has been bypassed, read or paraphrase the following:

The ceiling within this chamber is domed and enchanted with magic that casts bright light throughout the area. Etched in precise script along both walls of the hall are numerous names organized and aligned within columns. Recessed into the northern and southern walls are two formidable iron vault doors, circular in form. Their polished metalwork is embossed with the symbol of three circles overlapping to form a set of lips at their intersection. A lever on the eastern wall rests underneath a plaque that reads, "Treasure Vault Release."

These iron vault doors lead to a repository of remains belonging to followers of Lorlana. The names along the wall are a memorial to the dead who are interred within. Lyria enhanced the security of the vault knowing it would be too enticing for members of the Gravelight Sorority to bypass. The lever on the far wall not only opens the vault doors but also triggers the false floor and ceiling which threatens to drop the characters into a pit and bury them under the weight of thousands of coins.

Detection. A successful DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check discovers the floor or the ceiling has carefully concealed stonework designed to open.

Trigger. The trap activates when the lever is pulled.



Effect. The false floor divides the room in half and drops into a funnel. Creatures standing on the false floor who succeed on a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw manage to leap to safety within the vault doors which open when the trap is triggered. The character who pulls the lever by conventional means is too far away to do so. Characters who fail this saving throw and the character who pulls the lever fall into the funnel; this culminates in a 40-foot fall, causing 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage. In addition to the falling damage, characters who fall into the funnel begin to be buried by a torrent of coins released from the ceiling, taking 11 (2d10) bludgeoning damage at the end of each round, and are restrained. It takes 3 rounds for the pit to fill with the coins.

Countermeasures. Characters who tie a rope or otherwise anchor themselves before pulling the lever give themselves the opportunity of climbing back up out of the pit, with a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. Without a rope, climbing is impossible due to the torrent of coins. Attaching a mechanism such as a rope and grappling hook to the lever and pulling it from a distance may successfully trigger the trap without falling into the pit.

Reset. The trap must be manually reset.

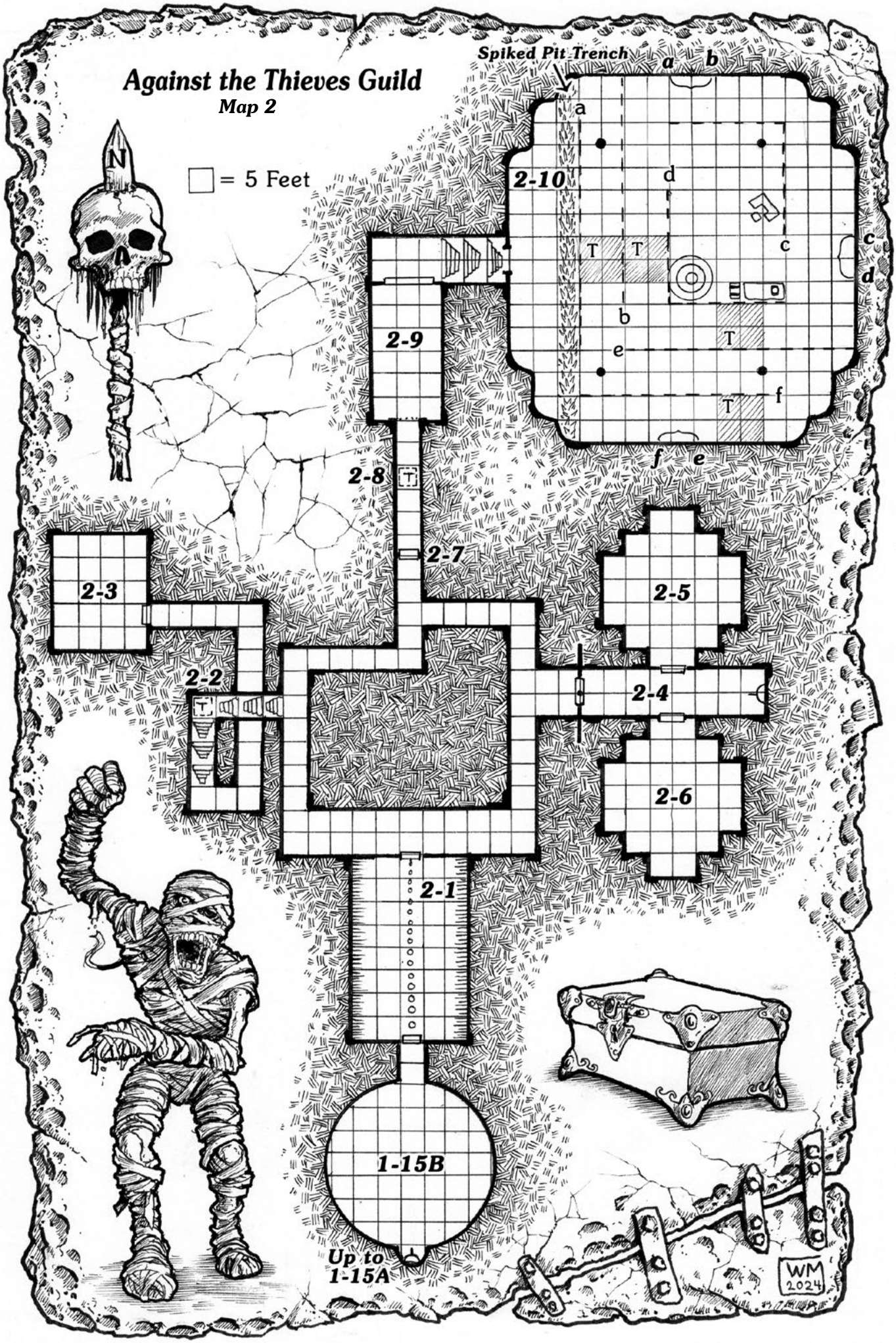
Treasure. The coins contained within the ceiling are fake iron coins enchanted to look like gold.

AREA 2-5 – NORTH SKULL OSSUARY

The walls of this chamber are lined with dozens of small niches, each containing a skull. At the center of this macabre gallery is a simple sarcophagus carved from a single slab of gray stone.

The untold secrets of Lorlana's worshipers are intended to be sacred and maintained by her worshipers, even beyond death. This vault is a place for the deceased worshipers of Lorlana to have their remains interred so they would be protected from the magic of diviners and necromancers who might compel the deceased to reveal their knowledge. Upon anyone entering the room, the lid of the sarcophagus slides open, and the awakened **mummy** guardian rises from its resting place to defend the vault.

Treasure. The northern vault's skulls belonged to scribes and spellcasters. The following *spell scrolls* can be found rolled up within the skulls: *arcane lock*, *arcanist's magic aura*, *clairvoyance*, *glyph of warding*, and *nondetection*. An iron ring worn by the mummy is set with a moonstone worth 150 gp. Inside the sarcophagus is a simple brass music box worth 75 gp.


Against the Thieves Guild
Map 2
N
= 5 Feet
Spiked Pit Trench
a
b
2-10
d
T
T
c
c
d
2-9
b
e
T
f
T
f
e
2-8
2-7
2-3
2-5
2-2
2-4
2-6
2-1
1-15B
Up to
1-15A
WM
2024

AREA 2-6 – SOUTH SKULL OSSUARY

This neglected ossuary contains many skulls held within niches cut into the stone walls. A weathered and cracked sarcophagus sits at the center of the chamber, its lid slightly askew.

Much like area 2-5, this chamber serves as a final resting place for the followers of Lorlana, though these skulls belong to individuals who broke their oaths to Lorlana. The **zombie** "guardian" of this chamber was never afforded the ritual to preserve its dignity, instead being placed here as a rotten animated corpse to serve as a reminder of their dishonor. It rises from the sarcophagus to attack as soon as anyone enters the chamber.

Treasure. Characters searching the skulls discover a total of seven gemstones (each worth 50 gp) concealed within them. The zombie is wearing a golden gorget worth 750 gp.

AREA 2-7 – GUILLOTINE DOOR

The end of this passageway contains a heavy-looking iron door spanning the entire height of the 10-foot-tall corridor.

Above this door is a slot which hides a heavy guillotine knife. The knife is kept up by the door itself. Its thin edges are coated with a rough substance, so it doesn't immediately fall once the door opens; it takes several seconds for its weight to overcome the friction.

Detection. A successful DC 18 Wisdom (Perception) check allows a character to notice the unusual smell of the chemical substance holding the knife, which can be identified with a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Nature) check as a rough, glue-like solution made from crushed beetles and sap. When attempting to open the door carefully, it barely moves; it appears to either be locked or stuck. A successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals it isn't locked and something is weighing down on it.

Trigger. The trap is triggered by opening the door.

Effect. Three seconds after the door opens, the guillotine blade falls, dealing 55 (10d10) slashing damage to a creature who passes through immediately after opening the door. This damage can be halved with a successful DC 18 Dexterity saving throw.

Countermeasures. The knife can be avoided by simply opening the door without walking through.

Reset. The trap must be reset manually. The knife needs to be lifted back up, after which the door must be quickly closed.

AREA 2-8 – DOUBLE SCYTHE

The trap in this hallway causes two powerful scythe blades to emerge from the ceiling and floor at the same time, swinging in opposite directions and threatening all creatures within 10 feet of the triggering pressure plate (marked on the map as "T").

Detection. A successful DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) check spots the slightly uneven stonework.

Trigger. A creature stepping on the pressure plate triggers the trap.

Effect. When activated, the trap makes two attacks against each creature within 10 feet of the pressure plate. The attacks have a +6 bonus to hit and deal 11 (2d10) slashing damage on a hit. If the first attack hits, the second attack roll is made with advantage. A creature hit by both attacks must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become paralyzed; this condition can only be removed by *greater restoration* or similar powerful magic.

Countermeasures. Each scythe can be disarmed with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

Reset. The trap must be manually reset by rotating the axle each scythe is attached to back to its original position.

AREA 2-9 – VAULT DOOR

A tapestry on the wall is woven from fine silk intermixed with gold and silver thread. Dominating the scene is a female deity with a stoic expression devoid of a mouth. Her clenched fist holds the tongues of a dozen unfortunate individuals who hang suspended in air from their open mouths.

A tall arched iron door is set into the northern wall. It is embossed with Lorlana's religious sigil. Dominating its center is a circular dial, intricate in design, festooned with five rings inscribed with letters. There is a mark to the right, perhaps indicating the five rings are to be lined up forming a code word to unlock it.

The door holds the spirit of a monk who served as a custodian for the labyrinth. He betrayed Lorlana's trust by sharing secrets he eavesdropped upon that were whispered by worshipers in the halls. As punishment, Lorlana had him imprisoned within this vault door, rendering him incapable of speech.

The spirit can manifest eyes within the face of the door which gaze at the party. Even in punishment, the loose-lipped monk still yearns to proudly display the secrets he knows with others. He can only communicate by blinking. He knows the combination to the door, but he is also lim-

ited in how he can communicate with the party. By blinking, he can provide "yes" and "no" responses to questions the party may ask of him. In doing so, they may be able to deduce the passphrase. After he answers 20 questions, his spirit's ability to manifest within the door ceases and he is incapable of reappearing until the next dawn.

The code for the combination lock is HONOR.

The dial on the door is connected to a trap linked with the floor.

Detection. A successful DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) check allows a character to notice a slight groove at the base of the wall just above the floor, indicating the floor can move.

Trigger. The trap is triggered each time the dial is turned to an incorrect letter of the combination.

Effect. When the dial is turned and lands on an incorrect letter, the floor slides 5 feet under the wall towards the door. The floor can retract six times before it disappears. A creature standing on the retracting floor when it withdraws the last 5 feet automatically falls. The pit below the floor is 70 feet deep. Anyone falling into it takes 24 (7d6) bludgeoning damage. The walls are smooth, requiring a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to climb. The entire pit area is shrouded in magical darkness, concealing two **grells** lurking patiently. It has been over a month since Zimgrazhan last fed them and they hungrily wait to reach up and attack with their tentacles any creatures choosing to leave the chamber through the hallway.

Countermeasures. A creature attempting to crack the safe without learning the combination must succeed on five DC 20 Intelligence checks using thieves' tools. The successful checks need not be consecutive. Each failed check causes the floor to withdraw 5 feet.

Reset. The trap automatically resets 10 minutes after the whole floor has slid under the wall, or immediately after the correct combination has been dialed on the safe.

AREA 2-10 – RELIQUARY VAULT

Beyond the door lies a massive vault bathed in the warm magical light cast from wall sconces surrounding the perimeter of the room. Towering high relief sculptures loom over the hall, each depicting an emotionless deity's face, her crystal eyes gazing down over the area. Arranged around the center of the chamber are a plush leather chair accompanied by a matching footstool, a writing desk, and a lavish bed with an ornate treasure chest at its foot. Standing in the middle of these furnishings is a thin, wiry-haired woman dressed in black leather holding a curious box of elegant craft. With profound reluctance, she stows away the object and draws her weapon.

This chamber once held the coffers of Lorlana which were used to reward those who shared their secrets. Now, it has been claimed by **Lyria, arcane infiltrator** (see appendix C) who has made it her personal sanctuary to isolate herself while she learns all she can from the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*.

Invisible Walls. The crystal eyes adorning the three Lorlana relief sculptures in the north, east, and south walls are enchanted with the ability to make objects invisible. Once used by the monastics to conceal their treasure, Lyria has harnessed the power of these statues on a series of walls to provide an advantage in combat. The network of invisible floor-to-ceiling stone walls (as depicted on the map by dashed lines) creates a maze that leads to the center of the room. Attempting to step into an invisible section of wall costs 5 feet of movement, and electing to feel for a wall while moving can be done at half speed.

Crystal Eyes. Each of the crystal eyes in the three Lorlana relief sculptures contains magically enchanted crystals responsible for the invisible walls. Each crystal eye is a small object with AC 13, 5 hit points, resistance to piercing and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks, and immunity to poison and psychic damage. When a crystal eye is destroyed, the corresponding wall becomes instantly visible. These crystals and the walls they are associated with are labeled on the map as "a," "b," "c," "d," "e," and "f."

Spike Pit Trench. A clearly visible trench filled with iron spikes runs from the north wall to the south wall. A character attempting to leap over a section of the trench may run into an invisible wall (section "a") and immediately plummet to the bottom of the 10-foot-deep pit, taking 11 (2d10) piercing damage from the spikes. The character must also make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a success.

Crushing Stone Trap. Pressure plates (marked on the map as "T") located within the invisible maze are subtly integrated into the floor design, requiring a successful DC 18 Wisdom (Perception) check to notice. If stepped upon, they activate a trap. A stone slab falls from the ceiling, threatening the 10-foot-square area of the pressure plate. Any character standing within that area must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a success. The stone slab remains intact and is designed to cover the entire width of the hall where it drops, cutting off easy access to the hall beyond. A character succeeding on a DC 12 Strength (Athletics) can climb to the top of a dropped stone.



Lyria's Tactics. Lyria knows she is outnumbered and attempts to use her knowledge of the maze and its traps to her advantage, intentionally setting some of them off to separate the group. She casts *invisibility* and proceeds to move stealthily through the labyrinth to trigger the crushing stone traps selectively. Her plan focuses on attempting to isolate a single party member to gain a strategic position; she preferably targets any spellcasters among the group if possible. While sections of the maze remain invisible, she uses *misty step* and *expeditious retreat* to maneuver to advantageous places within the maze, intentionally moving to where the characters will be led into a crushing stone trap.

Treasure. Lyria wears *+1 leather armor*, wields a *+2 shortsword* and a *+1 dagger*, and carries the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* (see appendix A) on her person. The treasure chest at the foot of her bed is locked, requiring a successful DC 18 Dexterity check using thieves' tools to open. Inside are 10 lustrous white pearls (worth 100 gp each), 750 gp, an *eversmoking bottle*, and a leather bag containing one packet of *dust of disappearance*.

CONCLUDING THE ADVENTURE

If the characters obtain the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*, they find themselves in possession of an item yielding unknown potential and incredible risk. While the temptation to discover a forbidden secret may be potent, Lyria's descent into obsession may be a cautionary tale for anyone considering the idea of using it. Players should be ready to accept these risks before their characters attempt to use the object.

If Sister Abbess is in communication with a member of the party via the *ring of mind shielding* found in area 1-8, she encourages the party to return it to members of the faith, to whom she can help lead the group. The Order of Lorlana would be willing to pay handsomely for the return of the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*, granting a party who does so 10,000 gp.

Another option would be to sell the object. There is no shortage of collectors who would relish having such an item, which could easily fetch 50,000 gp or more. Of course, doing so would likely continue to perpetuate the curse of the object on others.

APPENDIX A: NEW MAGIC ITEMS

CAPE OF DORIAN GREY

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement)

You gain a +1 bonus to AC and saving throws while you wear this cape.

Curse. If identified, this item appears to be a *cloak of protection*. The cape leeches age from its attuned owner, eating away their years to rejuvenate itself. Each day a creature is attuned to the cape, it sucks away the equivalent of 5 years' time, while its colors grow brighter, and its tattered ends reweave themselves.

After wearing the cape for 1 day, someone who knows the attuned creature that succeeds on a DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check realizes something is off about their look; a success on a DC 10 Wisdom (Medicine) check allows a character to identify the aging effect.

The curse and the attunement can only end with a *remove curse* spell or similar magic, or when the wearer dies (probably of old age). After the curse is removed, over the next week the cape's attractive appearance fades until it becomes as tattered as it was when first found. The aging effect is not reversed when the curse is broken. The lost years can only be recovered by a *greater restoration* spell cast within 24 hours of the curse being removed.

RELIQUARY OF THE SILENT SISTERS

Wondrous item, legendary (requires attunement)

This relic is an ornate box forged of mithril and accented with gold filigree. Patterned around the sides of the box are images of saints who hold a silent finger to their pursed lips. The front of the box yields a feminine face containing a complex dial where its mouth should be. The dial contains letters, numbers, and symbols.

The spiritual contents of this box are believed to contain all the secrets and knowledge shared with Lorlana.

Divine Insight. While attuned to the *Reliquary*, you can ask a question about a person, place, or object. To receive the response, you must concentrate on the device for the next 8 hours over which the *Reliquary* slowly provides an answer using its dial to provide either a direct or cryptic response. It is up to the GM's discretion regarding what knowledge Lorlana has received from her worshipers and is accessible via this means. You can use this ability three times per day, after which you can't use this property again until the next dawn.

Curse. The *Reliquary* bears a curse and anyone who is attuned to it risks being affected by it. Each time the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* is used to learn information, there is a cumulative 5% chance they fall victim to this curse. Even if the attunement ends after this curse has been bestowed, the curse remains. The curse has the following properties:

- You no longer require air, food, drink, or sleep. Your body stops aging.
- You become obsessed with learning everything you can from the *Reliquary*. Pursuing another activity other than asking it questions for more than 1 hour makes you irritable and imposes disadvantage on all attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws until you successfully receive new information from it.
- You refuse to willingly share what you have learned from the *Reliquary* with others. Nothing short of magical compulsion can make you reveal information obtained from using the artifact.
- Nothing short of a *wish* spell can remove this curse.

STORM GEM

Wondrous item, rare

This brilliant red-orange opal displays a breathtaking play of color in which flecks of luminous yellow, white, and even black give it the appearance of a stone set ablaze. A gem of this quality is worth approximately 1,000 gp to the right buyer.

Curse. The first time each day a creature in possession of the gem steps outdoors, the opal (and thus the character) is struck by a massive bolt of lightning. The wearer and each creature within 5 feet of them must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 22 (4d10) lightning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. This effect does not function again until the next dawn.

The *identify* spell does not explain the nature of the item's curse. If a character has access to a sufficient library or repository of magical knowledge, a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Arcana) check unearths a bit of the gem's history and provides guidance as to how one might strip it of its power. To free the *storm gem* of its enchantment, a practitioner of magic must cast *remove curse* upon it while standing on a hilltop during a lightning storm.

ZIMGRAZHAN'S TOOLBOX OF TRAP-SMITHING

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement)

This dark, iron-bound box is adorned with Infernal runes and contains a variety of sinister-looking tools specifically designed for trapmaking. It includes finely crafted pliers, cutters, wire, springs, and gears, and various arcane and mechanical components that seem to shift and change to suit the task at hand.

Trap Detection. The wielder can use an action to cast *find traps*. The toolbox can't be used this way again until the following dawn.

Trap Rearmament. As an action the toolbox can be used to rearm any simple mechanical trap without the need for a check. This feature does not work on magical or complex mechanical traps. The attuned creature may attempt to persuade the toolbox to disarm a trap in a similar way by making a DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion) check. On a success, the toolbox begrudgingly disarms the trap. On a failure, the toolbox goes to work and intentionally sets off the trap. This ability can be used twice per day and resets at dawn.

Infernal Improvisation. The toolbox can be commanded to improvise a trap using its own materials and those it magically summons from the hells. This takes 10 minutes and requires a sufficient environment for placing the improvised trap. When this ability is used, choose one of the following options or roll to see which trap is created:

- **Poisoned Dart Trap.** This trap is placed and concealed within a flat surface such as a wall and activated by a tripwire. It fires a volley of three darts at targets within 60 feet. Ranged attack, +6 to hit, 11 (2d10) poison damage on a hit.
- **Scorching Flame Trap.** This trap is placed within a flat surface such as a wall and activated by a pressure plate. It releases a 30-foot cone of fire. Each creature in the area must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) fire damage on a failure, or half as much damage on a success.
- **Net Snare Trap.** This trap is concealed within a ceiling and activated by a pressure plate. It releases a net that drops on anyone caught beneath it in a 15-foot-square area. Each creature in the area is restrained, and those failing a DC 13 Strength saving throw are also knocked prone. A creature can use its action to make a DC 13 Strength check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. The net is AC 10 and has 20 hit points.

Traps the toolbox creates can be detected with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check and can be disarmed with a successful DC 17 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. The trap is magical and can be discovered by spells and abilities that reveal magic.

Sentience. The toolbox is a sentient neutral evil item with an Intelligence of 17, a Wisdom of 10, and a Charisma of 12. It has hearing and darkvision out to a range of 120 feet.

The toolbox can speak, read, and understand Common and Infernal. It adopts the sound of the attuned character's voice and transmits thoughts telepathically (30 foot range).

Personality. The toolbox forms a complex relationship with its user. It revels in being used to construct sadistic traps designed to maim and kill. However, it quickly becomes impatient and at times attempts to manipulate its user into making mistakes and sabotaging themselves.

APPENDIX B: NEW MONSTERS

ANIMATED STONE BLOCK

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 105 (10d10 + 50)

Speed: 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
20 (+5)	3 (-4)	20 (+5)	1 (-5)	3 (-4)	1 (-5)

Damage Resistances: bludgeoning from nonmagical attacks; cold, fire, lightning

Damage Immunities: piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks; necrotic, poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, prone

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 6

Languages: —

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Antimagic Susceptibility: The block is incapacitated while in the area of an *antimagic field*. If targeted by *dispel magic*, the block must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against the caster's spell save DC or fall unconscious for 1 minute.

False Appearance: While the block remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal stone block.

Immovable Object: Creatures cannot move through or occupy the same space as the block.

Unusual Nature: The block doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

ACTIONS

Spike Trap: A series of steel spikes shoot out from concealed holes in the block. Any creature within 5 feet of the block must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, it takes 11 (2d10) piercing damage and becomes grappled and restrained (escape DC 14). On a success, it takes half as much damage and is not grappled.

Push: The block moves up to its speed. While doing so, it can enter Medium or smaller creatures' spaces. Whenever the block enters a creature's space, the creature must make a DC 12 Strength saving throw. On a success, the creature is pushed 5 feet back or to the side of the block, if possible. On a failure, a creature is pushed and falls prone, taking 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage as it is pushed along with the block. If there is no open space for a creature to move into, any creature caught by the Push automatically fails the saving throw and the damage increases to 21 (6d6) bludgeoning damage.

The surface of the stone block is worn and ancient. A heavy grinding sound echoes off the walls as it slowly glides through the corridor, moving with an unsettling sense of purpose.

HELL CAT

Medium Fiend, Typically Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 45 (7d8 + 14)

Speed: 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
13 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)

Skills: Perception +6

Damage Immunities: fire

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages: understands Infernal but can't speak it

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Feline Reflexes: The cat has advantage on Dexterity saving throws. Additionally, if the cat is subjected to an effect that allows it to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, the cat instead takes no damage if it succeeds on the saving throw, and only half damage if it fails.

Keen Smell: The cat has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Pack Tactics: The cat has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the cat's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage plus 7 (2d6) fire damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage.

Fire Breath (Recharge 5-6): The cat exhales fire in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in that area must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

This devilish feline prowls with a singed coat of fur and eyes gleaming with predatory instinct. Molten lava drips from its lower mandibles, and black smoke curls from its nostrils.

TRAP GOLEM

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 102 (12d10 + 36)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	3 (-4)	10 (+0)	1 (-5)

Damage Immunities: acid, poison, psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks not made with adamantine weapons

Condition Immunities: charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: understands the languages of its creator but can't speak

Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Death Trap: When it drops to 0 hit points, the golem begins to emit a rapid ticking sound from within its body. After 30 seconds (5 rounds) have passed, the golem explodes. Each creature within 20 feet of it must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) force damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. A creature can disable this effect with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

Immutable Form: The golem is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Magic Resistance: The golem has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons: The golem's weapon attacks are magical.

Unusual Nature: The golem doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The golem makes two Scythe Arm or Poison Dart attacks.

Scythe Arm: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) slashing damage.

Poison Dart: *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d6) piercing damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned for 1 hour. If the saving throw fails by 5 or more, the target is also unconscious while poisoned in this way. The target wakes up if it takes damage or if another creature takes an action to shake it awake.

Rolling Sphere (Recharge 5-6): Until the end of its next turn, the golem manipulates its body into a 5-foot-diameter rolling sphere of solid stone. When it activates this ability, it moves 60 feet in a straight line. Any creature in its path must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw or take 22 (5d8) bludgeoning damage and is knocked prone. On a success, a creature takes half as much damage and is not knocked prone.

REACTIONS

Counterspike: When the golem is targeted by a melee attack and takes damage from an attacker within 5 feet of it, a series of spikes shoot out from its body and attempt to impale the target. The attacker must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, it takes 5 (1d10) piercing damage and becomes grappled and restrained (escape DC 14). On a success, it takes half as much damage and is not grappled or restrained.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The golem can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. It can take only one legendary action at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The golem regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Attack: The golem makes one Scythe Arm attack.

Activate Trap: The golem activates a trap within 30 feet of it.

Conjure Pit Trap (Costs 2 Actions): The golem creates an extradimensional space in a 10-foot cube centered on a point within 30 feet of it which instantly becomes a spiked pit trap. A creature in the space when the pit trap appears falls in and takes 11 (2d10) piercing damage from the spikes. The pit trap remains until the golem conjures a new one. If a creature is still in the original pit it is forced to a nearby 5-foot square. A conjured pit trap is 10 feet deep, and a creature may climb out of it with a successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check.

Rising to a height of 12 feet, a monolithic figure crafted from interlocking stonework moves its head, a mahogany treasure chest, to scan the room. With every deliberate movement, the sounds of grinding stone and clicking gears hint at the myriad of traps hidden beneath its exterior.

APPENDIX C: NPCS

DARA, ACCURSED MASTER THIEF

Medium Undead, Neutral Evil

Armor Class: 16 (*cape of Dorian Grey*)

Hit Points: 105 (14d8 + 42)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
13 (+1)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)	17 (+3)

Saving Throws: Dex +7, Int +5

Skills: Acrobatics +9, Investigation +5, Perception +6, Persuasion +5, Stealth +9

Senses passive Perception 16

Languages: Common, Goblin

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** 2

Special Equipment: Dara wears a *cape of Dorian Grey* (see appendix A; not factored into saving throws) and *boots of elvenkind*.

Evasion: When subjected to an effect that allows a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, Dara takes no damage on a successful save or half damage on a failed one, provided Dara is not incapacitated.

Regeneration: Dara regains 10 hit points at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 hit point and isn't in sunlight. If she takes acid, fire, or radiant damage, this trait doesn't function at the start of her next turn. Dara is destroyed only if she starts her turn with 0 hit points and doesn't regenerate.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn): Dara deals an extra 14 (4d6) damage when she hits a target with a weapon attack and has advantage on the attack roll, or when the target is within 5 feet of an ally of Dara's that isn't incapacitated and Dara doesn't have disadvantage on the attack roll.

Turn Immunity: Dara is immune to effects that turn Undead.

Unusual Nature: Dara doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: Dara makes two Dagger attacks.

Dagger: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d4 + 5) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Disarm: Dara attempts to take control of a weapon or other item in a target's grasp. She makes a Dexterity (Acrobatics) check contested by the target's Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check. If Dara wins the contest, she gains control of the item.

REACTIONS

Uncanny Dodge: Dara halves the damage she takes from an attack made against her, provided she can see the attacker.

LYRIA, ARCANE INFILTRATOR

Medium Humanoid (Human, Rogue, Wizard), Neutral Evil

Armor Class: 17 (*+1 leather armor*)

Hit Points: 84 (13d8 + 26)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
9 (-1)	20 (+5)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws: Dex +8, Int +5

Skills: Acrobatics +8, Deception +5, Perception +7, Sleight of Hand +8, Stealth +11

Senses passive Perception 17

Languages: Common, Goblin

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Special Equipment: Lyria wears *+1 leather armor*, wields a *+2 shortsword* and a *+1 dagger*, and carries the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters* (see appendix A).

Cursed Nature: Due to the curse of the *Reliquary of the Silent Sisters*, Lyria doesn't age and doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Evasion: When subjected to an effect that allows a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, Lyria takes no damage on a successful save or half damage on a failed one, provided Dara is not incapacitated.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn): Lyria deals an extra 14 (4d6) damage when she hits a target with a weapon attack and has advantage on the attack roll, or when the target is within 5 feet of an ally of Lyria's that isn't incapacitated and Lyria doesn't have disadvantage on the attack roll.

Spellcasting: Lyria casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

- At will: *dancing lights*, *mage hand*, *minor illusion*
- 2/day each: *charm person* (as a 2nd-level spell), *invisibility*
- 1/day each: *expeditious retreat* (as a bonus action), *misty step* (as a bonus action)

ACTIONS

Multiattack: Lyria makes two *+2 Shortsword* or *+1 Dagger* attacks.

***+2 Shortsword*:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d6 + 7) piercing damage.

***+1 Dagger*:** *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit*: 8 (1d4 + 6) piercing damage.

Cacophony (Recharge 4-6): Each creature in a 15-foot cube originating from Lyria must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 9 (2d8) thunder damage and is pushed up to 10 feet away from Lyria. On a successful save, a creature takes half as much damage and isn't pushed.

Lightning Lance (Recharge 5-6): Lyria looses a bolt of lightning in a line that is 60 feet long and 10 feet wide. Each creature in the line must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 36 (8d8) lightning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

BONUS ACTIONS

Sleight of Mage Hand: Lyria performs a quick cast of *mage hand* which rakes the eyes, tugs an ear, or otherwise distracts a creature. Until the end of her turn, attack rolls against the creature have advantage.

REACTIONS

Uncanny Dodge: Lyria halves the damage she takes from an attack made against her, provided she can see the attacker.

APPENDIX D: PLAYER HANDOUTS

PLAYER HANDOUT 1

Dear Dara,

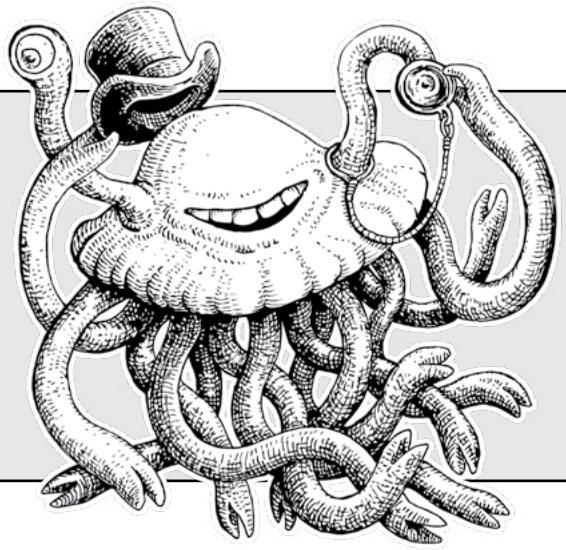
If you are reading this, then perhaps I underestimated you, again. Maybe all of this would have been avoided if I correctly assessed your capacity for betrayal. But let's not dwell on the past—this place I created for you has exhausted my capacity for regrets.

I will be brief with the sentimentalities. Your reward is that you have been forgiven—not that you ever asked for it. But as ever, I am the bigger person. And presumably you are still breathing, although depending on how you fared that might be a charitable assessment of your health. Each scar is a lesson—cherish them.

Consider our business as concluded. The Reliquary of the Silent Sisters is mine, safe within the dungeon's deepest vaults. I've found myself a cozy little nook, impervious and secure. It's quite charming, in a "surrounded-by-death" kind of way. We've played this out, Dara, and some games are just too dangerous to play a second time.

In the shadow of our allegiance,

Lyria



FLOG'S EYE SEES ALL!

News & Updates For Goodman Games 5E Fans

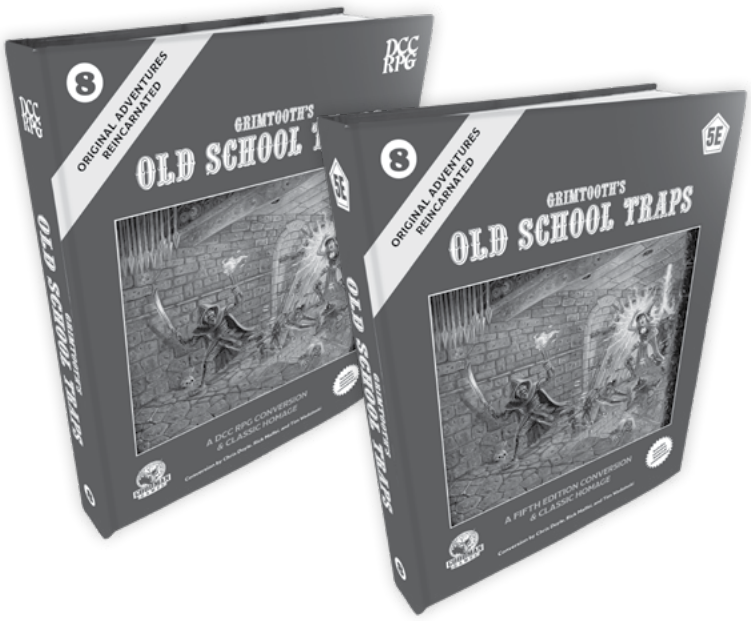
Well met, adventurers! It is I, Flog'istaulc, your personal guide on our journey through this essay. With my enchanted monocle, I observe the natural wonders and numinous curiosities of the multiverse. I perceive ancient histories, recent proceedings, or even things that have not yet come to pass. I now focus my lens on Grimtooth, master purveyor of old school traps!

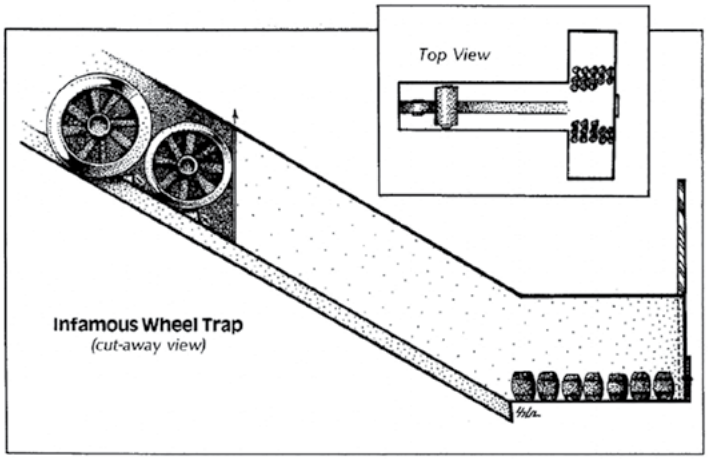
The Scribes at Goodman Games had a chance to catch up with the old Troll himself, Grimtooth, for a little question and answer session.

Goodman Games: Grimtooth, thank you for taking the time to open yourself up, and share a bit about the troll that designed so many traps.

Grimtooth: "Open yourself up?" I didn't realize we were going to be talking traps so early in the interview. I would say the Guillotine Door should do the trick to "open someone up?"

GG: Ahm. Well, yes. We'll get to that in a bit. Tell us about yourself. What do you do when not designing the next deathtrap, or selling them to dungeon engineers?





GT: I'm just like most trolls. I enjoy long walks along the lava beaches of the City of Brass, the occasional hike through the Forlorn Forest, and of course rock climbing the Cliffs of Insanity! But you know, sometimes, I just need a "me" day. That is when I grab a unicorn-hair bathrobe, my fuzzy slippers, and a good book. Something like S1 The Tomb of Horrors.

GG: In your recent book, Grimtooth's Old School Traps, the scribes at Goodman Games curated 150 of your best traps. Can you pick a favorite?

GT: Impossible! That is like picking your favorite trollkin, or your favorite hell hound. But, if I have to, I'll go with the Infamous Wheel Trap. I enjoy a good design that punishes delvers for overthinking.

GG: OK, well maybe you can tell us what your favorite type of trap is? The classic pit trap, or perhaps the spinning room?

GT: My favorite trap is one that gets triggered. Preferably over and over, by the same inept delver. But I also prefer my favorite traps to have a solid theme, and of course a neck-snappy title. Of course, the best traps are the ones that can be easily avoided, but the delvers blunder in anyway, often making it worse. I guess you could say I'm a fan of stupidity.



The Man Behind the Troll Mask

For those of you who followed the Grimtooth's Old School Traps crowdfunding project, undoubtably, you crossed (trapped?) paths with Grimtooth, himself. The persona of Grimtooth was brought to life by Thorin Thompson, friend of Goodman Games, and 3rd party publisher. Part WWF personality, part local used car salesman, and part blowhard, Thorin brought just the appropriate gravatas to the role. And with that hutz-pah, he elevated all of our shows and "commercials". We can't thank Thorin enough, for enduring hours in a sweaty mask, sucking on countless throat lozenges, and putting up with the scribe's incessant prattle.

GG: Dispel a common myth about your traps.

GT: Not all traps must be deathtraps. A trap that maims, or one that is even a mere nuisance can be effective. As long as the delver loses the use of one extremity, I'm good!

GG: It seems like you've been in the trap-design game for a long time. How many years have you been designing death-traps?

GT: It's been 2 years. Or maybe 222 years? Or maybe decades? I'm not sure. I'm not good at counting. Or keeping time…

GG: What is your favorite song?

GT: That is easy. "Do You Really Want to Hurt Me?," crooned by Culture Cudgel. To which I reply: "Yes, please!"

GG: A famous admiral once proclaimed, "It's a Trap!". How would you respond?

GT: Its probably true.

GG: Any words of inspiration for would-be trap-designers?

GT: Ask not how Grimtooth can mangle delvers for you. But for you to design diabolical deathtraps for delvers on your own.

GG: Grimtooth, thank you for your time.

GT: No worries. I'll send you an invoice.

A stirring jaunt into the insightful mind of a master trapsmith! Wonderful! Flog sees all, but extricates even more. What secrets shall be unearthed in a future fifth edition fantasy?

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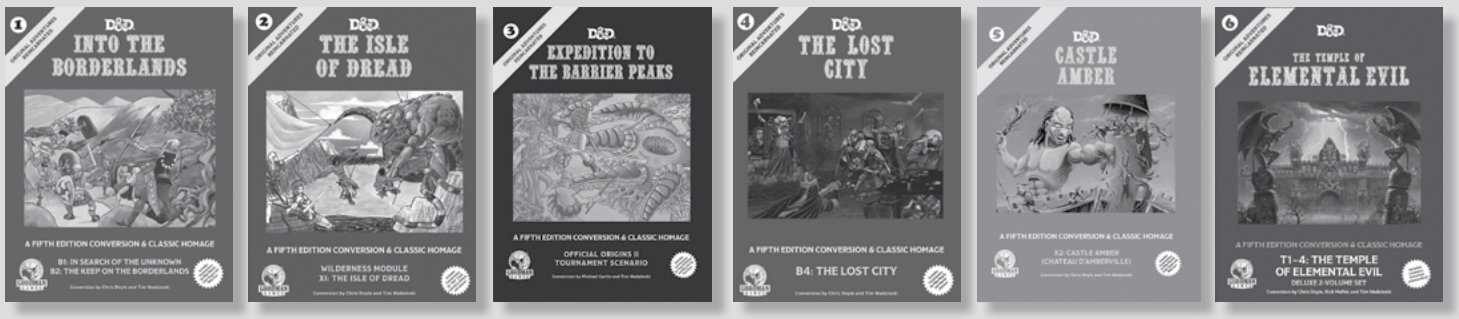
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